

BEYOND THE KINGDOM — Series Format Bible

Document 01 · Locked Canon · Format & Production Rules

In-universe "today": Monday, January 3, 2005 (Premiere Day)

1. Locked Facts (Canon — Do Not Change)

Item	Locked Value
Title	Beyond the Kingdom
Format	Daytime soap opera (serial drama), Monday–Friday
Series premiere (in-universe)	Monday, January 3, 2005
Present day	2005 — the story moves forward in real time from here
Setting	A fictional, private, gated luxury community in the affluent Atlanta, Georgia area
Core family	The Donohues — Victor, Joan, Jasmine, Natasha, and Alvin
Family identity	A "powerful and prestigious multigenerational family" — "Black Royalty"
Cast	Primarily African American, with a few non-Black characters
Storytelling tools	Screenplay-format scenes + in-world news/media headlines + 2005-era internet & fan reaction
Deliverables	Every document is also delivered as a PDF

Premise: Set in a fictional gated community in the affluent Atlanta area, *Beyond the Kingdom* tells the story of a wealthy Black family in a posh, gated community. At the center of the story is the Donohue Family — Victor, Joan, Jasmine, Natasha, and Alvin — a powerful and prestigious multigenerational family known as "Black Royalty."

Character bios, birthdays, and backstories arrive in the next document (Document 02 — Character Bible).

2. Episodes Per Year — 250

Answer: 250 new episodes per year.

- A real daytime soap airs every weekday — about 260 airdates per year.
- In 2005 there are 255 weekday airdates after the usual holiday preemptions (Memorial Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Thanksgiving, and the Christmas observance).

- Taking out about 5 more days for real-world preemptions (breaking news, sports, presidential addresses) leaves **250**. That is the real network daytime standard for a one-hour soap.
- Every broadcast week is 5 episodes, and the story moves on each weekday.

3. Season Numbering — The Broadcast-Season Model

Answer: Number seasons by the U.S. broadcast TV season, which runs from mid-September to mid-September. Number episodes cumulatively and never reset them.

Real daytime soaps work this way. They don't restart at "Episode 1" each season. The episode counter runs continuously (for example, *Episode #5,000*), and "seasons" are industry bookkeeping tied to the fall broadcast season. A soap that premieres mid-season (like ours, in January) has a shortened first season.

Season	Broadcast Window	Airdate Slots	New Episodes	Episode Numbers
Season 1 (Premiere Season)	Mon Jan 3, 2005 – Fri Sep 16, 2005	182	180	#0001 – #0180
Season 2	Mon Sep 19, 2005 – Fri Sep 15, 2006	254	250	#0181 – #0430
Season 3 and beyond	Mid-September to mid-September	~255	250	Continues cumulatively

How to reference an episode: *Season 1 · Episode #0001 · Monday, January 3, 2005*

Holidays with no new episode in Season 1: Memorial Day (Mon May 30, 2005), Independence Day (Mon Jul 4, 2005), Labor Day (Mon Sep 5, 2005). Two more Season 1 dates are held for real-world preemptions.

Sweeps periods (ratings months — the biggest cliffhangers, weddings, deaths, and reveals land here):

- February 2005 sweeps: about Feb 3 – Mar 2, 2005
- May 2005 sweeps: about Apr 28 – May 25, 2005
- November 2005 sweeps: about Oct 27 – Nov 23, 2005
- **Season finale:** Friday, September 16, 2005 — the biggest Friday cliffhanger of the year

4. Serialized vs. Standalone — 95% / 5%

Answer: 95% serialized, 5% standalone.

- **95% serialized:** Every episode continues the storylines from the day before. Storylines overlap, pick up where they left off, and pay off weeks or months later. This is the real daytime formula.

- **5% "standalone-feel" specials:** About 12–13 episodes a year. They still count in continuity, but each one centers on a single event or format:
 - Holiday episodes (Thanksgiving, Christmas, New Year's Eve)
 - Flashback / "family history" episodes about the Donohue legacy
 - A wedding, funeral, or gala shown across one full hour
 - "Two-hander" episodes (a single long confrontation between two characters)
 - Anniversary episodes
- **Continuity rule:** Nothing is ever "reset." Every event, injury, secret, marriage, birth, death, and lie is permanent canon unless the story itself changes it (a reveal, a lie exposed, a return).

Continuity Protocol

1. **Master Timeline Log:** Every scene carries a date and time stamp.
2. **Age Tracker:** Ages are calculated from locked birthdays and change on each birthday. A character's age on any date is always exact.
3. **No SORAS without an on-screen reason.** ("Soap Opera Rapid Aging" is a common soap trick. We avoid it to keep it real.)
4. **Story Ledger:** An ongoing list of open secrets (who knows what, and since when).
5. **Relationship Map:** Marriages, divorces, affairs, and paternity, all dated.

5. Genre, Subgenres, Rating & Runtime

Category	Answer
Primary Genre	Daytime Soap Opera / Serial Drama
Subgenres	Family saga · Dynasty/wealth drama · Romantic melodrama · Corporate & political power drama · Mystery/suspense · Legal drama · Crime thriller
Themes	Legacy, power, loyalty, betrayal, secrets, class within the Black elite, faith, ambition, love
Tone	Glamorous, high-stakes, emotional, realistic — "Black Royalty" behind the gates
Rating	TV-14 (D, L, S, V) — suggestive dialogue, strong language, sexual situations, violence (within daytime network standards)
Timeslot	One-hour weekday broadcast (e.g., 1:00–2:00 PM ET)
Runtime	60-minute slot · about 42 minutes of story (2005 network daytime hours ran about 18 minutes of commercials, promos, and credits)

6. Episode Titles

Answer: Real daytime soaps don't give episodes titles. Each episode is identified by its **episode number + air date**, plus an internal **production number**.

Official format:

BEYOND THE KINGDOM — Episode #0001

Air Date: Monday, January 3, 2005

Prod. #BTK-0001

Special exception: Landmark episodes get an in-world promo "event name" for press, ads, and fans. Examples:

- "The Premiere" (Ep #0001)
- "The Donohue Gala" (a sweeps event)
- "The 100th Episode" (Ep #0100)
- "Season Finale" (Ep #0180)

These names appear only in marketing, soap-magazine headlines, and fan chatter. They never replace the number and date.

7. Script Length, Acts & Scenes

Element	Standard
Script length	75–90 pages (target: 80 pages) for a one-hour daytime episode. Daytime scripts are dialogue-heavy and multi-camera, so they run longer than a primetime hour.
Structure	Teaser (Cold Open) + 6 Acts
Scenes	24–30 scenes per episode (target: 28)
Storylines per episode	3–5 storylines rotated through the acts
Scenes per act	Teaser: 1–2 · Acts 1–6: 4–5 each
Act breaks	Every act ends on a "hook" (a reveal, a slap, a stare, a doorbell). Act 6 ends on the day's cliffhanger.
Friday rule	The Friday cliffhanger is the biggest of the week. It keeps the audience coming back Monday.

Episode Template

1. **Title Card:** Episode #, air date, production #, in-universe dates covered
2. **TEASER (Cold Open):** Picks up exactly where the last episode ended
3. **Main Title Sequence**

4. **ACT ONE – ACT SIX:** Scenes rotate between storylines
5. **Cliffhanger Tag**
6. **"Next on Beyond the Kingdom" preview**
7. **Media & Fan Layer:** News headlines, press, and fan posts reacting to that episode's events

Screenplay Scene Format

INT. [LOCATION] - [DAY/NIGHT]
[Day, Month Date, 2005 – Time]

[Action lines in present tense.]

CHARACTER NAME (age)
(parenthetical)
Dialogue.

8. Storytelling Layers (2005 Period Accuracy)

The story is told through three layers:

A. Screenplay Scenes — character-driven dialogue that drives the drama.

B. News & Media (2005 outlets and formats)

- Local Atlanta print and TV news, business pages, society columns, and gossip columns
- National Black media (magazines, cable entertainment news, radio)
- Business press for Donohue corporate storylines
- Soap magazine coverage (weekly soap digests, covers, spoilers)

C. The Internet & Fans — only what existed in 2005

- **Available in 2005:** Soap message boards and forums, AOL, email chains, fan sites, LiveJournal, Xanga, BlackPlanet, MySpace, Blogger/blogs, text messaging (SMS), two-way pagers/Sidekicks/BlackBerrys, flip phones (e.g., Motorola RAZR)
 - **Facebook:** Limited to college students in 2005
 - **YouTube:** Launches in 2005 (public beta in spring). Not usable in January 2005.
 - **Not yet available — never use in 2005 scenes:** Twitter (2006), iPhone (2007), Instagram (2010), smartphone apps, hashtags as a trend culture, streaming services
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9. Timeline & Age Rules

- Every scene carries an **in-universe date and time** (e.g., *Monday, January 3, 2005 — 7:42 PM EST*).
- Atlanta is in **Eastern Time**. EST applies until DST begins on **Sunday, April 3, 2005**, then EDT until **Sunday, October 30, 2005**.
- **Ages are calculated from each character's exact birthday**. A character born June 10, 1950 is **54** on January 3, 2005 and turns **55** on June 10, 2005.
- Birthdays are on-screen events when they matter to the story.
- One airdate usually covers one story day. Timelines can compress (several episodes covering one gala night) or skip (a time jump announced on screen).

10. Quick Reference Summary

Question	Answer
Episodes per year	250 (5 per week, Mon–Fri)
Season numbering	Broadcast season (Sep–Sep); cumulative episode numbers. Season 1 = Jan 3 – Sep 16, 2005 (Eps #0001–#0180)
Serialized / Standalone	95% / 5%
Genre	Daytime Soap Opera / Serial Drama
Subgenres	Family saga, dynasty drama, romance, corporate/political drama, mystery, legal, crime
Rating	TV-14 (D, L, S, V)
Runtime	60-min slot / about 42 minutes of story
Episode titles	Episode # + air date + production # (event names for landmark episodes only)
Script length	75–90 pages (target 80)
Acts	Teaser + 6 Acts
Scenes	24–30 (target 28)

Next: Document 02 — Character Bible (to be provided by the creator).

BEYOND THE KINGDOM — Character Bible

Document 02 · Locked Canon · Core Families & Principal Characters

All ages are exact as of Premiere Day: Monday, January 3, 2005

How to Read This Bible

- **Age (1/3/05)** is the exact age on premiere day. **Next birthday** shows the age they turn during 2005. Run ``python3 tools/ages.py YYYY-MM-DD`` for any date.
 - **"Black Don't Crack" rule:** Every character looks noticeably younger than their age. A **Looks** line gives the on-screen appearance age range for casting and description.
 - **SECRET** marks canon that is hidden from other characters, and sometimes from the audience. Nothing marked SECRET may be revealed on screen without a planned story arc.
 - All principal characters in this document are African American.
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Quick Age Reference — Premiere Day (Mon. Jan 3, 2005)

Character	Born	Age 1/3/05	2005 Birthday
Simone Donohue	Nov 2, 1910	94	Turns 95 — Wed Nov 2 (Nov sweeps)
Theodore Donohue	Jul 31, 1934	70	Turns 71 — Sun Jul 31
Victor Donohue	May 30, 1936	68	Turns 69 — Mon May 30 (Memorial Day)
Joan Donohue	Apr 17, 1938	66	Turns 67 — Sun Apr 17
Alvin Donohue	Oct 8, 1970	34	Turns 35 — Sat Oct 8
Peter Olson	Nov 13, 1959	45	Turns 46 — Sun Nov 13
Jasmine Olson	Mar 23, 1960	44	Turns 45 — Wed Mar 23
Martin Olson	May 15, 1981	23	Turns 24 — Sun May 15
Mallory Olson	Jun 5, 1985	19	Turns 20 — Sun Jun 5
Robert Bullock	Feb 10, 1959	45	Turns 46 — Thu Feb 10
Natasha Bullock	Jun 2, 1961	43	Turns 44 — Thu Jun 2
Elxa Jackson	Aug 29, 1980	24	Turns 25 — Mon Aug 29
Jeremy Jackson	Dec 2, 1980	24	Turns 25 — Fri Dec 2
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Jan 5, 1982	22	Turns 23 — Wed Jan 5 (Episode #0003)
Grace Bullock	Apr 12, 1984	20	Turns 21 — Tue Apr 12

Character	Born	Age 1/3/05	2005 Birthday
Amond Baker	Feb 10, 1982	22	Turns 23 — Thu Feb 10 (same birthday as Robert Bullock)
Esther Smilley	Sep 20, 1982	22	Turns 23 — Tue Sep 20
Arianna Cummings	Oct 25, 1982	22	Turns 23 — Tue Oct 25
Harmony Divine	Jun 19, 1982	22	Turns 23 — Sun Jun 19 (Juneteenth)
Emma Smilley	May 10, 2002	2	Turns 3 — Tue May 10 (May sweeps)
Victoria Smilley	May 10, 2002	2	Turns 3 — Tue May 10 (May sweeps)
Lyric Solace Baker	Apr 20, 2002	2	Turns 3 — Wed Apr 20

THE DONOHUE FAMILY

Alexander Josiah Donohue — The Founder (Deceased)

- **Born:** March 14, 1905, Americus, Georgia · **Died:** December 31, 1999, 11:58 PM, Donohue Manor, Belmont Crest (aged 94)
- Founder of Donohue Global Holdings and co-founder of Belmont Crest. He was born the son of sharecroppers and walked into Atlanta at 16 with three dollars sewn into his coat lining. He built the largest fortune in human history.
- He died two minutes before the year 2000. Family legend says he "refused to see a century he didn't build."
- His 1996 **Codicil to the Crown Trust** named his great-grandson Marc-Anthony the Heir Apparent. That decision still divides the family (see Document 03).
- **Quote carved over the Manor fireplace:** *"They closed every door, so I built the house."*

Simone Toussaint Donohue — The Queen Mother

- **Born:** November 2, 1910, New Orleans, Louisiana · **Age:** 94 · **Looks:** early 70s
- Creole of color and a licensed pharmacist (Xavier University of Louisiana, Class of 1931). Her apothecary formulas became the seed of Donohue Health & Beauty.
- Co-founder of Belmont Crest. In 1959 she stood on her porch with a shotgun while a cross burned at the front gate. The next morning she served the reporters coffee.
- She lives in the **Dowager House** at Belmont Crest. She still attends every Crown Council meeting and still has a vote. Everyone, including Victor, is afraid of her.
- **Holds:** "The Savannah Letter," the one document that proves what really happened between Alexander and Cornelius Smilley in 1952 (see Document 05).

- **Voice:** Soft Creole lilt, devastating one-liners, never raises her voice. *"Baby, I buried a husband, a century, and three governors. Don't try me before lunch."*
- **Relationship to Marc-Anthony:** He is her "Sunshine." He has Sunday dinner with her every week without fail.

Theodore Alexander Donohue — The Passed-Over Son

- **Born:** July 31, 1934 · **Age:** 70 · **Looks:** late 50s
- Eldest son of Alexander and Simone. Howard University School of Law. Fulton County District Attorney 1971–1987, then senior counsel to Donohue Global Holdings until he retired in 1999.
- **Respected, powerful, influential, corrupt, and ruthless.** As DA he buried cases for friends, built cases against enemies, and kept files on everyone in Georgia. Those files still exist, in a climate-controlled vault under his house.
- **The wound:** In 1966 Alexander gave Donohue Hospitality Group to Victor. In 1996 he gave the chairmanship of Donohue Global Holdings to Victor too. Theodore has smiled at every family dinner for 39 years and has forgotten nothing.
- **Married:** Three times. His current wife is **Constance "Connie" Donohue** (38; see Document 07). His son is **Reginald Donohue** (47; see Document 07).
- **SECRET:** Theodore is quietly advising Martin Olson on how to take the Heir Apparent designation away from Marc-Anthony. He plans to use Martin to put Theodore's branch of the family back on the throne.
- **Voice:** Courtroom baritone, Southern gentility, velvet threats. *"I don't hold grudges, nephew. I hold receipts."*

Victor Donohue — The King

- **Born:** May 30, 1936 · **Age:** 68 · **Looks:** mid-50s
- Youngest son of Alexander and Simone. Morehouse College '57, Harvard Business School '59.
- **Chairman & CEO, Donohue Hospitality Group (1966–1996).** He turned his father's Auburn Avenue hotel into the world's largest luxury hospitality empire.
- **Chairman & CEO, Donohue Global Holdings (1996–present).**
- **Respected, powerful, influential, ruthless, dangerous, and astronomically wealthy.** He negotiates by staying silent. Senators take his calls on the first ring, and his enemies sometimes hear from him only after their companies are gone.
- **Married:** Joan Mercer on **Saturday, June 20, 1959**, in the first wedding ever held at Belmont Crest Chapel.
- **Children:** Jasmine (1960), Natasha (1961), Alvin (1970).
- **With Marc-Anthony:** Victor sees himself in his grandson and worries about that. Victor privately suspects Marc is hiding something enormous. He hasn't asked, because he isn't sure he wants the answer.
- **Voice:** Measured, low, final. *"In this family we don't raise our voices. We raise our prices."*

The Honorable Joan Mercer Donohue — The Judge

- **Born:** April 17, 1938, Atlanta (Vine City) · **Age:** 66 · **Looks:** early 50s
- Spelman College '59. Married Victor two weeks after graduating. She was one of the few Black women in her Howard University School of Law class and graduated in 1964.
- Civil rights litigator from 1964 to 1979. She argued desegregation, voting rights, and fair-housing cases across the Deep South.
- **U.S. District Judge, Northern District of Georgia (1979–2003)**, appointed by President Carter. She took senior status and retired in 2003.
- **Respected, powerful, influential, astronomically wealthy philanthropist.** She chairs the **Donohue Foundation**.
- The moral center of the family, and the only person who can make Victor apologize. She believes in the law, which puts her in quiet, permanent conflict with her husband, her son-in-law Robert, and (without her knowing it) her favorite grandson.
- **Voice:** Precise, warm, withering. *"Objection, sustained, and sit down."*

Alvin Mercer Donohue — The Prince of Nightlife

- **Born:** October 8, 1970 · **Age:** 34 · **Looks:** late 20s
- Youngest son of Victor and Joan. He was a "surprise" baby born nine years after Natasha, and he has been spoiled rotten from the start.
- **A literal party boy.** He owns stakes in three Atlanta nightclubs (**Velvet**, **Sanctuary**, and **The Onyx Room**), a strip club he swears he doesn't own, and a Miami yacht nicknamed "The Alibi."
- **Deeply involved in politics:** He's a top Democratic fundraiser, bundles donations for city council, the state house, and Congress, and knows where every politician in Georgia drinks.
- **Deeply involved in the underworld:** He owes money and favors to **Silas Merriweather**, Atlanta's old-school kingpin (see Document 07). He launders club cash for people Victor has never heard of.
- **Sleeps around and never uses protection.** Nobody knows how many children he has, including Alvin.
 - **SECRET (seeded): Tremaine Banks** (12), son of **Rochelle Banks** of College Park, is Alvin's son. Rochelle has never asked for a dime. Tremaine has the Donohue eyes. More possible children are held in reserve for future stories.
- **With Marc-Anthony:** Alvin is Marc's favorite uncle and a terrible influence. Marc has quietly cleaned up three of Alvin's messes, and Alvin has no idea who did it.
- **Voice:** Loud, charming, a little too drunk. *"Mama says I'm the family's black sheep. I said, Mama, I'm the family's whole farm."*

THE OLSON FAMILY

Congresswoman Jasmine Donohue Olson — The Politician

- **Born:** March 23, 1960 · **Age:** 44 · **Looks:** mid-30s
- Eldest child of Victor and Joan. Spelman '81, Georgetown Law '84.
- **U.S. Representative from Georgia (1987–present).** She was sworn in January 1987 at age 26, among the youngest women ever elected to Congress. She represents the north-metro Atlanta district that includes Belmont Crest. (Following soap convention, the district is never given a real number on screen.)
- She sits on the House Ways and Means Committee and is openly mentioned as a future Senate candidate. Privately she has vice-presidential ambitions.
- **Married:** Dr. Peter Olson, Saturday, June 14, 1980. Their marriage is a genuine love match that is also a political partnership.
- **Children:** Martin (1981), and Mallory (1985), her "miracle child." Mallory came after a devastating 1983 miscarriage and doctors telling her she would never carry again.
- **Blind spot:** She sees Martin's hunger as ambition and cannot see that it's something darker.
- **Voice:** Poised, polling-tested, lethal off-mic. *"I have 700,000 constituents, Martin. Don't make me choose."*

Dr. Peter Olson — The Surgeon

- **Born:** November 13, 1959, Detroit, Michigan · **Age:** 45 · **Looks:** late 30s
- Son of an auto-plant foreman and a schoolteacher. He earned everything himself: University of Michigan '80, Johns Hopkins MD '84, residency and fellowship at Emory.
- **Chief of Plastic Surgery, Atlanta Presbyterian Medical Center.** Founder of **Olson Facial & Aesthetic Surgery** in Buckhead. He is dual board-certified in Plastic Surgery and Otolaryngology (ENT).
- **Respected, powerful, insanely wealthy.** Half the faces in Buckhead society are his work, and he keeps all of their secrets.
- Loves Jasmine deeply and worships Mallory. Where Martin is concerned he is quietly afraid, because he once saw what Martin did to a dog when Martin was nine.
- **Voice:** Gentle Midwestern calm. *"I can fix anything but a face that lies."*

Martin Donohue Olson — The Rival

- **Born:** May 15, 1981 · **Age:** 23 · **Looks:** early 20s
- Eldest child of Peter and Jasmine, and **the eldest grandchild of Victor Donohue.** He was born eight months before Marc-Anthony and believes that makes the throne his by right.
- Princeton '02 (economics, summa cum laude). **Senior Vice President of Strategic Development, Donohue Global Holdings.**

- **Marc-Anthony's fierce rival and sworn enemy.** Their rivalry started over toys, grew over grades, and became permanent on **Sunday, October 13, 1996**, when the Codicil was read aloud and Martin, then 15, heard his 14-year-old cousin named Heir Apparent.
- **He wants to be the Donohue Heir and take over the company.**
- **Astronomically deadly.** Martin is an expert marksman and a trained fighter who has studied poisons, and he has no conscience at all.
 - **SECRET:** Martin has killed three people as of 2005, each an "accident": a Princeton rival (1999), a blackmailing girlfriend (2002), and a DGH whistle-blower (2004). None of the deaths has been connected to him.
 - **SECRET:** He employs a private operator, **Cyrus Knox** (see Document 07), and has quietly started talks with **Desmond Smilley**, a Donohue enemy.
 - **SECRET:** Martin is hunting for the identity of "Sovereign," the boss of the Blackwater Syndicate, so he can destroy the organization and take credit for it. **He has no idea Sovereign is Marc-Anthony.** When he finds out, the war begins.
- **Voice:** Smooth, courteous, cold. *"Everyone loves Marc. That's what makes it so easy."*

Mallory Simone Olson — The Miracle Child

- **Born:** June 5, 1985 · **Age:** 19 · **Looks:** late teens
- Youngest child of Peter and Jasmine, and their "miracle."
- Very intelligent and business-savvy. Spelman College junior (economics), taking a lighter course load to run her father's practice as **Office Manager of Olson Facial & Aesthetic Surgery**. She has grown its revenue 40% in 18 months.
- **Spoiled and a daddy's girl.** She has a black AmEx, a white Range Rover, and she calls Peter "Daddy" in board meetings.
- **Planning to launch her own business with her cousin Grace: "GRACE & GLORY"**, a luxury beauty and lifestyle brand of skincare, fragrance, and cosmetics built on Great-Grandmother Simone's original 1930s apothecary formulas.
- **A virgin.** Her choice, her values, her business. It's never played as a joke.
- **Story seed:** She is falling, against every rule, for **Quentin Smilley** (see Document 05), a party boy from the enemy family.
- **Voice:** Bright, fast, a little bratty. *"Daddy, I didn't spend the money. I invested it in my happiness."*

THE BULLOCK FAMILY

Robert Lee Bullock, Esq. — The Fixer

- **Born:** February 10, 1959, Savannah, Georgia · **Age:** 45 · **Looks:** late 30s
- Son of a longshoreman. Morehouse '80, Yale Law '83.

- **Founder & Managing Partner, Bullock & Associates, LLP (1985–present).** It's the most feared criminal-defense firm in the South, with offices in Atlanta, Miami, New York, D.C., and Los Angeles.
- **Respected, powerful, influential, astronomically corrupt, astronomically ruthless, and insanely wealthy.** He has never lost a murder trial. Rumor says that's because some witnesses never make it to trial.
- **Married:** Natasha Donohue, Saturday, September 19, 1981. They're a power couple, and more partners in crime than a romance. They still genuinely want each other.
- **Children:** Elxa (1980, born before the wedding; a family "scandal" that's now a punchline), Marc-Anthony (1982), Grace (1984).
- **SECRET:** Robert has a long-running affair with his senior partner **Camille Rhodes** (see Document 07).
- **SECRET:** In late 2004, Robert and Victor privately leaned on the mayor to make Elxa Chief of Police. **Elxa doesn't know.**
- **Voice:** Silk and gravel. *"Innocent? Son, innocent is a price point."*

Natasha Donohue Bullock — The Queen of Hospitality

- **Born:** June 2, 1961 · **Age:** 43 · **Looks:** early 30s
- Middle child of Victor and Joan. Spelman '82, Wharton MBA '85.
- **CEO, Donohue Hospitality Group (1996–present).** She runs more than 3,100 hotels, resorts, casinos, cruise properties, and private clubs across 140 countries.
- **Respected, powerful, influential, ruthless, dangerous, insanely wealthy.**
- **She likes to bend the rules, and her son gets it from her.** She has bribed a Monaco zoning board, blackmailed a Las Vegas regulator, and once bought a Caribbean island to win an argument.
- **With Marc-Anthony:** He's her heart and her co-conspirator. She suspects he has secrets and has decided never to ask. "A mother knows when not to know."
- **Voice:** Glamorous, blunt, amused. *"Rules are for people without lawyers. I married a lawyer."*

Chief Elxa Bullock Jackson — The Law

- **Born:** August 29, 1980 · **Age:** 24 · **Looks:** early 20s
- Eldest child of Robert and Natasha. She was a gifted student who skipped two grades. Georgia State University B.S. in Criminal Justice (1999, age 18) and M.S. in Criminology (2001).
- Joined the **Atlanta Police Department** as soon as she met the minimum age. She rose through the ranks at a speed nobody in APD had ever seen:
 - Patrol officer (2001), then Detective in the Major Crimes/Homicide unit (2002).
 - Solved the **"Peachtree Strangler" murders** (2003) and made **Lieutenant, Homicide** (2004).
 - Her unit's clearance rate was the highest in APD history.

- **Chief of Police, Atlanta Police Department.** Appointed by Mayor Josephine Whitaker and sworn in **Monday, December 20, 2004**. She's the youngest big-city police chief in American history.
 - **Storyline:** Her appointment is a firestorm. Critics call her the "Nepotism Chief" (her father-in-law is the retiring chief and her family is the Donohues). Supporters point to her record, which is spotless.
 - **SECRET:** Her father and grandfather quietly pushed the mayor to appoint her. Elxa believes she earned it on merit alone, and her record says she did.
- **The complete opposite of her brother.** Elxa does everything **by the book**, and the book is her religion.
- **Married:** Detective Jeremy Jackson, **Saturday, October 16, 2004**, at Belmont Crest Chapel.
- **Her #1 case:** The **Blackwater Syndicate**. She has promised the city she will bring down "Sovereign." **She has no idea she's hunting her little brother.**
- **Voice:** Clipped, controlled, cop-flat. *"I don't do favors, Marc. I do warrants."*

Marc-Anthony Bullock — The Heir Apparent

- **Born:** Tuesday, January 5, 1982, Crawford Long Hospital, Atlanta · **Age:** 22 (turns **23** on Wednesday, January 5, 2005, in Episode #0003) · **Looks:** early 20s
- Second child and only son of Robert and Natasha. Grandson of Victor and Joan. Great-grandson of Alexander and Simone.
- **Billionaire Heir and Primary Heir Apparent of the Donohue family**, named by Alexander's 1996 Codicil. Under its terms he becomes eligible to take the **Vice Chairmanship of Donohue Global Holdings on his 25th birthday (January 5, 2007)** and the Chairmanship when Victor steps down. The clock is ticking, and Martin knows it.
- **The Golden Boy of the Donohue Family.**
- **Education:**
 - Graduated Belmont Crest Academy at 12 (1994).
 - **Morehouse College**, B.S. Mathematics and B.A. Economics, 1997 (age 15).
 - **Harvard**, joint **J.D./M.B.A.**, 2001 (age 19).
- **IQ:** A reported **250**, the highest ever recorded. He has a reputation for exceptional intelligence: he reads a 400-page contract in 20 minutes, speaks nine languages, and plays chess against three people at once while roasting all of them.
- **Founder, Chairman & CEO, Blackwater Security International (BSI), 2002–present** (see Document 06).
- **SECRET (maximum clearance): Founder & Boss of the Blackwater Syndicate (2000–present), known only as "SOVEREIGN."** Only the Syndicate's inner circle, "The Seven," know his face. Arianna Cummings knows but is not a member.
- **Net worth:** Forbes' publicly estimated figure is **\$38.6 billion (2005)**. The true figure, counting everything off the books, is much higher. His **future personal net worth will pass \$990 billion and keep rising every single day.**

- **Personality:**
 - **The sweetest, kindest, most loving, compassionate, innocent, and pure man in the world.** He tips waiters 100%, remembers every staff member's kids' birthdays, and cries at movies.
 - **But hurt someone he loves and he becomes a monster: a dangerous, unstoppable man.** There's no middle setting.
 - **A certified crash-out.** (Writers' shorthand only: Harry Potter and Percy Jackson times 2000. In-universe, Percy Jackson won't be published until June 2005.) When he snaps, cars flip, buildings burn, and companies vanish by morning.
 - **Bends the rules and takes creative liberties** whenever the rules or laws are unjust, unfair, or ridiculous. His motto: *"The law is a floor, not a ceiling."* He's the complete opposite of his older sister Elxa.
 - **Exceptionally outgoing and charismatic.** He's a natural in the spotlight and on camera, and the tabloids love him.
 - **Natural appearance, distinctive features, and effortless charisma.**
 - **Genuinely hilarious.** His comedy is unhinged, unfiltered, and offensive, and nobody is safe, including himself and his grandfather.
- **His #1 ultimate dream: A family, a big, gigantic family.** Kids are **non-negotiable**. He believes in **generational wealth**.
 - **Kids love him and he loves kids.** He mentors 40 boys through the Donohue Foundation, reads to the pediatric ward at Eggleston Children's Hospital every other Thursday, and is godfather to Lyric Solace Baker.
 - **SECRET (dramatic irony): He already has two daughters, twins Emma and Victoria Smilley, and has absolutely zero idea.**
- **Love interest / soulmate: Esther Smilley.** They have not met yet as themselves, and their story won't start right away.
 - **SECRET:** They met exactly once, masked, on the night of **Saturday, September 1, 2001**, at a Labor Day weekend masquerade (see Esther below). Marc remembers only a gold mask, a laugh, and the smell of jasmine. He has quietly looked for "the woman in the gold mask" ever since.
- **Relationships:** Ride-or-die with Grace. Brotherhood with Amond. Unbreakable friendship with Arianna. Loving, argumentative war with Elxa. Blood feud with Martin. Adores Simone, Joan, and Nana Ruby (the Bullock housekeeper). Currently on-and-off with news anchor **Celeste Vaughn** (see Document 07).
- **Residences:**
 - **The Bullock Pavilion**, 25 Sovereign Way, Belmont Crest.
 - The 58th-floor penthouse of BSI Tower in Midtown.
 - A villa in St. Barthélemy.

- **Voice:** Sweet, fast, filthy, brilliant. *"I'm the nicest man you'll ever meet. Now touch my sister again and meet the other guy."*

Grace Natasha Bullock — The Star

- **Born:** April 12, 1984 · **Age:** 20 · **Looks:** late teens
- Youngest child of Robert and Natasha.
- **Respected and powerful actress and singer.**
 - Starred as "Keisha" on the UPN sitcom **Sweet Tea** (2000–2004).
 - Her debut album **Amazing Grace** (Oct 2004) went platinum in six weeks. The lead single is "Crown Me."
 - She's now shooting her first major studio film.
- **Planning to launch her own business with her cousin Mallory: GRACE & GLORY** (see Mallory).
- **Ride-or-die with her brother.** She would literally hide a body for him.
 - **SECRET:** On the night of **Saturday, July 15, 2000**, when she was 16, Marc and Amond saved her from men who drugged her at a Buckhead party. She knows the men were never seen again. She has never asked what happened. That night is the reason the Blackwater Syndicate exists (see Document 06).
- **Voice:** Sunny, sassy, fierce. *"I love my brother. I own a shovel. Those facts are unrelated."*

Detective Jeremy Jackson — The Boy Scout

- **Born:** December 2, 1980 · **Age:** 24 · **Looks:** early 20s
- Son of **former APD Chief Harold Jackson** (see Document 07). Clark Atlanta University '02.
- **Senior Detective, APD Homicide.** He's the department's best interrogator.
- **A Boy Scout (literally an Eagle Scout) who does things 100% by the book.** He has never taken a free coffee.
- **Married:** Elxa, October 16, 2004. **Storyline:** His wife is now his boss's boss's boss. His marriage, his career, and his pride are on a collision course.
- Likes Marc personally but doesn't trust him. He is the first person to notice that the Blackwater case and the Bullock family keep crossing paths.
- **Voice:** Earnest and stubborn. *"Rules are what keep us from becoming them."*

THE INNER CIRCLE

Amond Baker — The Right Hand

- **Born:** February 10, 1982 · **Age:** 22 · **Looks:** early 20s
- Son of **Dr. Curtis Baker** (dentist) and **Gloria Baker** (high school principal). They're an **upper-middle-class** family in the Magnolia Terrace section of Belmont Crest (see Documents 04 and 07).
- **Marc-Anthony's best friend, brother, and right-hand man** since kindergarten at Belmont Crest Academy. Morehouse '04 (business).
- Publicly: **Senior Vice President of Strategic Operations, BSI.**
- **SECRET: Underboss of the Blackwater Syndicate**, "The Right Hand." He's second only to Sovereign.
- **He wants to become a respected, powerful, ruthless, dangerous, and corrupt businessman.** He grew up next to billionaires and is tired of being "the dentist's son."
- **Father of Lyric Solace Baker.**
 - Lyric was conceived in July 2001 after one night with **Harmony Divine** at a Midtown club.
 - Harmony tracked him down in February 2002, and a DNA test confirmed he's the father. Amond acknowledged Lyric immediately and pays generous support through attorneys.
 - Marc-Anthony is Lyric's godfather.
 - **But Amond and Harmony don't really know each other.** They co-parent through lawyers, nannies, and 10-minute handoffs in the Phipps Plaza parking deck.
- **Love interest:** Harmony Divine. Their story becomes an on-again, off-again, toxic, electric relationship once they finally have to talk to each other.
- **Voice:** Cool, calculating, hungry. *"Marc was born a king. I have to be made one."*

District Attorney Arianna Cummings — The Right Hand Woman

- **Born:** October 25, 1982 · **Age:** 22 · **Looks:** early 20s
- Daughter of media mogul **Franklin Cummings** and cardiologist **Dr. Yvette Cummings**. They're an **upper-class** family on Kingsridge Drive, Belmont Crest (see Document 07).
- **Marc-Anthony's female best friend, sister, and right-hand woman.**
- **A prodigy:**
 - Spelman College at 14, B.A. at 16 (1999).
 - **Emory University School of Law**, J.D. at 18 (2001).
 - Passed the Georgia Bar in July 2001 and was **admitted October 2, 2001**, three weeks before turning 19.
- **Fulton County District Attorney.**
 - Won the November 2, 2004 election over incumbent DA **Lawrence Tate**, who collapsed after a bribery scandal broke in September.
 - Georgia requires three years of active bar membership. She qualified by exactly **31 days**.
 - **Sworn in Saturday, January 1, 2005**, two days before the premiere.

- She wants to become Attorney General of Georgia.
 - **SECRET (maybe, maybe not):** She has skeletons in her closet that Marc helped bury.
 - **The truth:** On New Year's Eve 2001 (early Tuesday, January 1, 2002, at about 2:40 AM), Arianna, 19 and drunk, hit and killed a man on a dark stretch of road off Northside Drive. She called Marc, not 911. By sunrise the car had been crushed and the body was gone. The victim was never reported found.
 - **SECRET within the secret:** The man was **Darnell "Dee" Divine**, the missing older brother of Harmony Divine. Harmony has been searching for him for three years.
 - **SECRET within the secret within the secret:** Marc also knows who tipped off the Tate scandal that got Arianna elected, because he did it.
 - Arianna knows Marc is Sovereign. She's **not** a member. She protects him with plausible deniability, and he protects her with silence.
 - **Voice:** Crisp, brilliant, guilty. *"Justice is blind, Marc. That's why I keep one eye open."*
-

THE WOMAN IN THE GOLD MASK

Esther Odessa Smilley — The Heiress

- **Born:** September 20, 1982, Chicago, Illinois · **Age:** 22 · **Looks:** early 20s
- **Billionaire heiress of the Smilley family.** Youngest of three children of **Lucius and Vivienne Smilley**. Full family in Document 05.
- **Her parents' designated heir** to Smilley International, chosen over her older siblings **Luke** and **Delphine**. They have never forgiven her.
- Northwestern University, B.S. (2004), and the youngest person ever admitted to Kellogg's Executive MBA program. **President, Smilley International Atlanta**, the division leading the company's January 2005 headquarters move from Chicago to Atlanta, straight into Donohue territory.
- **1000% ruthless and corrupt.** She'll bribe, blackmail, seduce, sabotage, and smile the whole time.
- **The most beautiful and attractive woman in the world, all natural.** She's been on the cover of *Vogue*, *Essence*, *Ebony*, *Jet*, and *Forbes*.
- **Her best friend and sister:** Harmony Divine, her freshman roommate at Northwestern.
- **Love interest / soulmate: Marc-Anthony Bullock.** He doesn't know it yet, and their story won't start right away.
- **SECRET (the show's biggest secret):**
 - On **Saturday, September 1, 2001**, Labor Day weekend, Esther, just shy of 19, went to a private masquerade at a Sag Harbor Hills estate on Long Island. She wore a gold mask, drank too much, and spent the night with a funny, beautiful stranger in a black mask. He gave her a fake name ("Tony").

- She found out who he really was 11 weeks later, when she saw Marc-Anthony Bullock laughing on the cover of *Black Enterprise*. He's the heir of the family her family hates most.
- **She was pregnant with twins.** She decided alone to keep the secret and raise the girls as Smilleys.
- **Cover story:** She publicly chose IVF with an anonymous sperm donor. The tabloids called her "the youngest billionaire single mother by choice," and the world believed it.
- Only Esther knows the truth. Even Harmony believes the donor story.
- **Why it matters (see Document 03):** Under the Crown Trust Codicil, the Heir Apparent's line of succession runs through his children. **Emma and Victoria are Donohue heirs.** If the secret comes out, the two warring dynasties are joined forever.
- **Avoidance pattern:** Esther has skipped every event where Marc might appear, including Lyric's christening (where Marc became godfather). She always has a different excuse.
- **Voice:** Silk over steel. *"I don't need a man, a donor, or your permission. I need you out of my building."*

Harmony Divine — The Best Friend

- **Born:** June 19, 1982 (Juneteenth) · **Age:** 22 · **Looks:** early 20s
- Daughter of **Calvin Divine** (MARTA bus operator) and **Loretta Divine** (Grady Memorial ER charge nurse). They're a **middle-class** family from the Cascade Heights neighborhood of southwest Atlanta (see Document 07).
- Went to Northwestern on a full academic scholarship, where she roomed with Esther Smiley. They've been sisters ever since.
- **Wants to become a respected and powerful real estate broker.** She got her Georgia real estate license in 2004 and is an agent at a small Buckhead brokerage, where she's hungry and underestimated.
- **Mother of Lyric Solace Baker** with Amond Baker. See Amond for how that happened.
- **Missing brother: Darnell "Dee" Divine** vanished on New Year's Eve 2001. Harmony has posted flyers, bothered APD, and run a LiveJournal called **"Find Dee"** every week for three years. **She has no idea the District Attorney killed him.**
- **Love interest:** Amond Baker. It's on-again, off-again, toxic, and irresistible.
- **Voice:** Warm, funny, relentless. *"I'm not pushy. I'm motivated. There's a difference and it's a commission."*

THE CHILDREN

Emma Alexandra Smiley — The Elder Twin

- **Born:** Friday, May 10, 2002, 4:12 AM, Northwestern Memorial Hospital, Chicago · **Age:** 2 · **Looks:** 2
- Eldest daughter of Marc-Anthony Bullock and Esther Smilley. **Older twin by 6 minutes.**
- **Future canon:** 1000% a daddy's girl, spoiled by him endlessly, but she understands the true meaning of hard work. Respectful and responsible.
- **Nearly all of her talent and personality is inherited from Marc.**
 - At 2 she's already reading picture books aloud, doing 24-piece puzzles face-down, and correcting adults' grammar.
 - She has his dimples and his laugh. Esther hears it every day and it scares her every time.

Victoria Simone Smilley — The Younger Twin

- **Born:** Friday, May 10, 2002, 4:18 AM, Northwestern Memorial Hospital, Chicago · **Age:** 2 · **Looks:** 2
- Daughter of Marc-Anthony Bullock and Esther Smilley. **Younger twin.**
- **Future canon:** 1000% a daddy's girl, endlessly spoiled, but she knows the true meaning of hard work. Respectful and responsible, **and a literal wild child (contained).**
- **Nearly all of her talent and personality is inherited from Marc.**
 - She has already escaped two cribs, one nanny, and a Four Seasons presidential suite.
 - She's funny on purpose at age 2.
- **Name note:** Esther named her after "victory." She doesn't know that Victor Donohue is the girls' great-grandfather. The middle name "Simone" was Esther's grandmother Odessa's suggestion. Nobody at Ravenhurst knows it matches the Donohue matriarch's name. It's a coincidence nobody has noticed yet.

Lyric Solace Baker — The Angel

- **Born:** Saturday, April 20, 2002, Piedmont Hospital, Atlanta · **Age:** 2 · **Looks:** 2
- Daughter of Amond Baker and Harmony Divine. **Goddaughter of Marc-Anthony Bullock.**
- A literal sweetheart and an angel. She sings to strangers, shares every snack, and hugs dogs, security guards, and the occasional mall Santa.
- **Dramatic irony:** Lyric's best playmates are "Emmie and Tori," Aunt Esther's twins. The three little girls play together every week, and **Marc's goddaughter is best friends with Marc's secret daughters.**

Master Secrets Ledger (as of 1/3/2005)

#	Secret	Who Knows	Who Must Never Find Out (Yet)
1	Marc-Anthony is the father of Emma & Victoria	Esther only	Marc, Harmony, both families
2	Marc-Anthony is "Sovereign," boss of the Blackwater Syndicate	Marc, Amond, The Seven, Arianna	Elxa, Jeremy, Martin, the FBI
3	Arianna killed Darnell Divine (Jan 1, 2002)	Arianna, Marc	Harmony, Amond, the Divines
4	Marc leaked the Tate scandal to get Arianna elected	Marc	Arianna, Elxa
5	Victor & Robert pushed the mayor to appoint Elxa	Victor, Robert, Mayor Whitaker	Elxa, Jeremy
6	Martin has killed three people	Martin, Cyrus Knox	Everyone
7	Theodore is coaching Martin to take the Heir Apparent designation	Theodore, Martin	Victor, Simone
8	Martin is in talks with Desmond Smilley	Martin, Desmond	Both families
9	Tremaine Banks is Alvin's son	Rochelle Banks	Alvin, the Donohues
10	Robert's affair with Camille Rhodes	Robert, Camille	Natasha
11	What really happened in Savannah, 1952	Simone (the Savannah Letter)	Everyone
12	Marc & Esther's night in Sag Harbor	Esther knows it was Marc; Marc knows only "the gold mask"	Everyone

Continued in Document 03 (Donohue Global Holdings), Document 04 (Belmont Crest), Document 05 (The Smilleys), Document 06 (Blackwater), and Document 07 (Supporting Cast).

DONOHUE GLOBAL HOLDINGS — The History of an Empire

Document 03 · Locked Canon · Corporate History, Structure & Succession

"They closed every door, so I built the house." — Alexander J. Donohue

At a Glance (as of January 3, 2005)

Item	Detail
Legal name	Donohue Global Holdings, Ltd. ("DGH")
Type	Privately held multinational holding company / global conglomerate
Founded	Donohue Enterprises, Inc. incorporated Monday, November 2, 1931. The DGH holding company was formed Monday, March 1, 1971.
Founder	Alexander Josiah Donohue (1905–1999)
Headquarters	Donohue Tower , 1 Donohue Plaza, 3200 Peachtree Road NE, Buckhead, Atlanta, Georgia 30305. 88 stories, completed 1992.
Chairman & CEO	Victor Donohue (since 1996)
Heir Apparent	Marc-Anthony Bullock (named 1996)
Valuation	\$10 trillion. The largest, most valuable company in the world.
Family fortune	More than \$2.5 trillion. The wealthiest family in the world.
Employees	About 4.1 million, directly and through controlled subsidiaries
Countries	171
Ownership	100% of voting control held by the Crown Trust (the Alexander & Simone Donohue Family Trust)
Motto	<i>Aedificamus quod negatum est.</i> ("We build what was denied.")

How the empire is built:

- **Donohue Global Holdings** is the **financial umbrella** above everything. It rarely operates companies directly.
 - It holds controlling interests through **subsidiaries, investment vehicles, trusts, and controlling stakes**.
 - **Donohue Enterprises** is the family's **operating empire**, the management company that runs the day-to-day businesses.
-

Part One — The Boy From Americus (1905–1923)

- **Tuesday, March 14, 1905:** Alexander Josiah Donohue is born in a two-room sharecropper's cabin outside Americus, Sumter County, Georgia. He is the fourth of seven children of **Josiah and Hattie Donohue**.
 - He learns arithmetic by counting the landowner's cotton weights and catches the landowner cheating his father by 11 pounds a bale. When he is ten, he tells his father so. His father whips him for saying it out loud, then quietly starts weighing his own cotton.
 - **1921:** At 16, after the landowner's son beats his younger brother, Alexander leaves home. He walks and rides freight trains 135 miles to Atlanta with **three dollars sewn into his coat lining**. He later says that was the only money he ever kept "just in case."
 - **1921–1923:** He works as a redcap porter at Atlanta's **Terminal Station**. He sees Black travelers step off trains with no taxi willing to carry them and no hotel willing to house them, and he sees an industry that doesn't exist yet.
-

Part Two — Sweet Auburn (1924–1945)

- **1924 — Donohue Transfer Company:** With \$200 in porter's tips, Alexander buys a used **Model T** and starts a jitney service carrying Black passengers from Terminal Station to Auburn Avenue. By 1926 he has **14 cars** and a moving-wagon line.
- **1927 — The Donohue House:** He buys a 12-room boarding house on Auburn Avenue. Every guest gets clean sheets, a hot breakfast, and a shoeshine. It's full every night.
- **October 1929 — The Crash:** Alexander doesn't trust white banks and has kept his savings in cash in a floor safe. When the market collapses, **he's one of the few men in Atlanta with money**. From 1930 to 1933 he buys **31 distressed Auburn Avenue and Old Fourth Ward properties** at pennies on the dollar.
- **Monday, November 2, 1931 — Donohue Enterprises, Inc. is incorporated** in the State of Georgia with a capital of \$41,000. Alexander is 26.
- **1932:** In New Orleans on business, Alexander walks into the **Toussaint Apothecary** on Dumaine Street to buy headache powder. He meets the pharmacist, **Simone Toussaint**, 21 and one of the first Black women licensed as a pharmacist in Louisiana. She charges him double because he's rude, and he comes back every day for two weeks.
- **Saturday, June 10, 1933: Alexander marries Simone** at St. Augustine Church in New Orleans. She moves to Atlanta and brings her formulas with her.
- **July 31, 1934:** Son **Theodore** is born.
- **1935 — Toussaint Laboratories:** Simone founds a hair- and skin-care company that sells door to door through a network of 3,000 "Toussaint Ladies" across 11 states. It later becomes **Donohue Health & Beauty**, the foundation of **Donohue Pharmaceuticals**.
- **May 30, 1936:** Son **Victor** is born.

- **Saturday, August 1, 1936 — The Hotel Donohue opens:** 150 rooms on Auburn Avenue with a rooftop supper club and a ballroom that seats 600. It appears in the first edition of *The Negro Motorist Green Book*. The Black press calls it "**the Waldorf of Sweet Auburn.**" Duke Ellington, Cab Calloway, Joe Louis, and Lena Horne stay there over the years.
- **1938 — Donohue Savings & Trust Company** is chartered. It lends to the Black homeowners and businesses that white banks turn away. It later becomes **Donohue Financial**.
- **1941–1945 — World War II:**
 - **Donohue Victory Services** wins contracts for laundry, catering, and transport at segregated military installations across the Southeast.
 - Alexander buys war bonds by the million, **on the condition that the newspaper photograph the purchase.**

Part Three — The Green Book Empire & The Savannah Betrayal (1946–1957)

- **1946–1952:** The Donohue Hotel chain spreads across the segregated South to Birmingham, Memphis, Charleston, Durham, Jackson, Nashville, and New Orleans. Each one is the best hotel a Black traveler can legally sleep in.
- **1948 — Donohue Mutual Life Insurance Company** is founded.
- **The Rival:** In Chicago, **Cornelius Smilley**, a former Pullman porter, has built the **Smilley Hotel Company**, the Green Book giant of the North (see Document 05). The two men are the most powerful Black hoteliers in America.
- **Friday, March 7, 1952 — The Savannah Betrayal:**
 - Alexander and Cornelius meet at a private house on Jones Street in Savannah to sign the merger that would create **Donohue-Smilley Hotels**, a coast-to-coast Black hospitality monopoly.
 - **At the last minute, Alexander tears up the contract.**
 - **The Donohue version:** Alexander learned Cornelius had secretly agreed to sell the combined company to a white-owned national chain. That chain would have fired every Black manager and turned the hotels into "colored annexes."
 - **The Smilley version:** Alexander used the negotiations to steal Cornelius's expansion plans, then walked away and built hotels in every one of Cornelius's target cities.
 - **The truth (LOCKED, SECRET):** *Both stories are partly true.* Cornelius was talking to the white chain, but only to get a better price out of Alexander. Alexander *did* use Cornelius's plans, which Simone copied from Cornelius's briefcase the night before. Simone kept the proof: "**The Savannah Letter,**" Cornelius's handwritten note explaining the bluff, which Simone intercepted and hid. **Alexander died without ever reading it.**
 - The two families have been at war ever since.

- **1955–1957:** Alexander begins secretly buying land in northwest Buckhead through white intermediaries (see Document 04, Belmont Crest).
-

Part Four — Belmont Crest & the Movement (1958–1970)

- **1958:** Alexander and Simone found **Belmont Crest** (see Document 04).
 - **1960–1965 — The Civil Rights Years:**
 - The Donohues quietly bankroll the movement: **bail money for the 1960 Atlanta Student Movement sit-ins**, buses and hotel rooms for marchers, and legal fees for voting-rights cases.
 - Alexander never allows his name on a donor list. *"The Klan can read."*
 - Joan Mercer Donohue, not yet a lawyer, types movement legal briefs through the night while pregnant with Natasha (born June 2, 1961). She graduates from Howard Law in 1964.
 - **1964 — Civil Rights Act:** Legal segregation ends. Alexander's advisers expect the Green Book hotels to die as Black travelers go to the white chains. **Alexander bets the opposite:** that Black travelers will want **luxury**, not just permission.
 - **Monday, January 3, 1966 — Donohue Hospitality Group (DHG) is formed. Victor Donohue, 29, is named Chairman & CEO.** Theodore, 31, is not. The brothers' cold war begins.
 - **Saturday, April 13, 1968: The Donohue Atlanta** opens on Peachtree Street: 52 stories and 1,100 rooms, the most luxurious hotel in the South. The opening is held in quiet mourning nine days after Dr. King's assassination. Victor dedicates the lobby's eternal flame to him.
 - **1969–1970:** DHG opens The Donohue in New York (Fifth Avenue), Washington, D.C., and Nassau.
-

Part Five — Going Global (1971–1989)

- **Monday, March 1, 1971 — Donohue Global Holdings, Ltd. is formed** as the parent holding company over every family business. The Crown Trust is created the same day to hold 100% of the voting shares forever.
- **1971:** Theodore becomes Fulton County District Attorney. Alexander calls it "a consolation prize with a badge."
- **1973 — The Oil Crisis:** DGH buys oil and gas stakes in Texas, the North Sea, and Nigeria. **Donohue Energy** is born.
- **1975–1979:** Hotels open in London (Park Lane), Paris, Lagos, Accra, Nairobi, Rio, and Tokyo. Victor refuses every offer to build in apartheid South Africa: *"We'll open in Johannesburg the day Mandela checks in."* (The Donohue Johannesburg opens in 1995, and Mandela attends.)
- **1979:** Joan Donohue is appointed to the U.S. District Court.
- **1980–1985:**

- **Donohue Media** launches the **Donohue Broadcast Network (DBN)**, a cable network, in 1983, and buys radio groups and magazines.
 - **Donohue Technologies** is founded in 1982, as the personal computer arrives.
 - **1985:** Robert Bullock founds Bullock & Associates. DGH becomes its first client.
 - **Monday, October 19, 1987 — Black Monday:** The market crashes 22.6% in one day. **Alexander, 82, repeats 1929.** DGH spends \$19 billion in 10 days buying blue-chip stakes at the bottom.
 - **1987:** Jasmine Donohue Olson takes her seat in Congress.
 - **1988–1989: Donohue Aerospace & Defense** is created through acquisitions. **Donohue Shipping & Logistics** buys a global fleet.
-

Part Six — The Tower, the Codicil & the Millennium (1990–1999)

- **1992: Donohue Tower** opens in Buckhead: 88 stories, the tallest building in the Southeast.
 - **1990s:** DGH expands into pharmaceuticals, biotechnology, telecommunications, satellites, commercial real estate, agriculture, food and beverage, sports, and private equity.
 - **1996 — The Year of Succession:**
 - **Monday, June 3, 1996:** Alexander, 91, steps down. **Victor becomes Chairman & CEO of DGH. Natasha, 35, becomes CEO of Donohue Hospitality Group.**
 - **July–August 1996:** The **Centennial Olympic Games** come to Atlanta. DGH is a founding patron, and DHG hosts 60 national delegations.
 - **Sunday, October 13, 1996 — The Codicil:** At Sunday dinner at Donohue Manor, the family attorney reads **Alexander's Codicil to the Crown Trust** aloud. It names **Marc-Anthony Bullock, age 14, as Heir Apparent.** Alexander has watched the boy for years: his genius, his heart, and the fact that he once organized a strike by the Manor's household staff for better pay and won.
 - The room goes silent. Martin Olson, 15, walks out. Theodore stays and smiles.
 - **Friday, December 31, 1999, 11:58 PM: Alexander Josiah Donohue dies** at Donohue Manor, aged 94, holding Simone's hand. Marc-Anthony, 17, is at his bedside. Alexander's last words are to him: ***"Don't let them make you small."***
 - His funeral at Belmont Crest Chapel on **Friday, January 7, 2000**, draws two former presidents, 41 heads of state, and 12,000 mourners lining West Paces Ferry Road.
-

Part Seven — The Modern Empire (2000–2005)

- **2000–2002:** After the dot-com crash, DGH buys distressed technology companies.
- **After September 11, 2001:** Donohue Aerospace & Defense and Donohue Technologies grow enormously. DGH is also among the **first contract clients of Blackwater Security International**

(founded 2002). The board votes 9–1 to hire the Heir Apparent's new company. The one "no" vote comes from a trustee who sits for Theodore's branch of the family.

- **2003:** DGH's valuation passes **\$8 trillion**.
 - **2004:** DGH's valuation reaches **\$10 trillion**. The company commits **\$25 billion** to rebuilding HBCU campuses nationwide.
 - **December 2004: Smiley International announces it will move its world headquarters from Chicago to Atlanta.** Victor reads the news, sets down the paper, and says only: *"Tell my mother."*
-

The Crown Trust & the Rules of Succession (LOCKED)

- **The Crown Trust** (the Alexander & Simone Donohue Family Trust) holds **100% of DGH's voting shares**. Family members hold non-voting economic interests and receive dividends. Only the Trust votes.
- **The Crown Council** is the Trust's governing body. It has nine seats:

Seat	Holder (2005)
1	Simone Donohue (Founder's Seat, for life)
2	Victor Donohue (Chairman)
3	Joan Donohue
4	Theodore Donohue
5	Jasmine Donohue Olson
6	Natasha Donohue Bullock
7	Alvin Donohue
8	Marc-Anthony Bullock (Heir Apparent's Seat, non-voting until age 25)
9	Independent Trustee — Judge Harlan Whitcomb Jr. (the son of Alexander's white 1950s land intermediary)

The 1996 Codicil — Key Clauses

1. **The Heir Apparent** is Marc-Anthony Bullock.
2. **Age of Accession:** He takes a full vote and becomes **Vice Chairman-designate at 25 (January 5, 2007)**. He becomes Chairman when Victor retires, dies, or is incapacitated.
3. **The Disgrace Clause:** If the Heir Apparent is **convicted of a felony** or proven by a **two-thirds Council vote** to have "brought ruin or disgrace upon the name," the designation passes to the next eligible heir chosen by the Council.
 - **Martin's whole strategy is built on this clause.** Proving Marc is Sovereign would trigger it.
4. **The Line of Issue:** After the Heir Apparent, succession passes **"to his issue, of body, in order of birth."**

- **SECRET BOMB: Emma Smiley (born first by 6 minutes) is second in line to control the most valuable company on Earth.** Victoria is third.
- Martin, the Olsons, and Theodore's branch all fall behind two toddlers being raised by the rival family.

5. **The Founder's Veto:** While Simone lives, she can **veto any Council decision once per calendar year**. She has never used it.

Corporate Structure

Donohue Global Holdings, Ltd. is the umbrella. It holds, through subsidiaries, trusts, investment vehicles, and controlling stakes:

Division	Business	2005 Chief Executive
Donohue Enterprises, Inc.	Operating and management company for the whole empire	Victor Donohue
Donohue Hospitality Group	3,100+ hotels, resorts, casinos, cruise lines, private clubs in 140 countries. Brands include The Donohue, Crest Resorts & Spas, Auburn House, Toussaint Retreats, and Sovereign Casinos.	Natasha Donohue Bullock
Donohue Financial	Donohue Bank & Trust, Donohue Capital (private equity), Donohue Mutual Life, asset management	Harrison Lyle III
Donohue Energy	Oil and gas, pipelines, utilities, early solar and wind	Dr. Adaeze Nwachukwu
Donohue Pharmaceuticals & Health & Beauty	Drugs, biotechnology, hospitals, Toussaint beauty brands	Dr. Lorraine Beckwith
Donohue Technologies	Software, semiconductors, telecom, satellites	Kenneth Oyelaran
Donohue Media	DBN cable network, film studio (Crest Pictures), 212 radio stations, magazines, record label (Auburn Records)	Franklin Cummings (board); President: Monique Sayles
Donohue Aerospace & Defense	Aircraft, avionics, government systems	Gen. (Ret.) Curtis Holloway
Donohue Shipping & Logistics	1,400-ship fleet, ports, freight rail, air cargo	Olufemi Adebayo
Donohue Realty	Commercial towers, land, Belmont Crest Holdings	Reginald Donohue (Theodore's son; a contested appointment)
Donohue Foods & Agriculture	11 million acres of farmland, beverages, grocery brands	Evelyn Stroud
Donohue Sports & Entertainment	Stakes in international football clubs, arenas, the Crest Classic golf tournament	Alvin Donohue (a figurehead title)
The Donohue Foundation	Global philanthropy	Joan Donohue , Chair

(Non-family executives are supporting characters who can be developed later.)

The Donohue Foundation — "Spare No Expense"

- **Endowment:** \$420 billion. **Annual giving:** more than \$30 billion. It is the most generous charitable institution in human history.
 - **Signature programs:**
 - **The Alexander Scholars:** full rides plus a \$50,000 annual stipend for 25,000 students a year, with priority for HBCUs.
 - **Simone's Table:** free groceries and pharmacies in 3,000 food deserts.
 - **The Hattie Donohue Housing Trust:** down-payment grants for first-generation homeowners, named for Alexander's mother.
 - **Crest Clinics:** free hospitals across the rural South, Africa, and the Caribbean.
 - **The Mercer Justice Project:** Joan's program, providing free appeals for the wrongfully convicted.
 - **The rule:** No Donohue charity event ever uses a paper plate.
-

Corporate Culture & Traditions

- **Sunday Dinner at the Manor:** Every Sunday at 4:00 PM. Attendance is expected. Business is forbidden at the table, which means everyone talks business in the hallway.
- **The Founder's Breakfast:** Every March 14 (Alexander's birthday), every DGH employee worldwide gets a free hot breakfast and a shoeshine.
- **The Three Dollars:** Every Donohue child gets three dollars in a sewn pouch on their 16th birthday. Marc-Anthony still carries his.

See Document 04 for Belmont Crest, and Document 05 for the Smilley rivalry.

BELMONT CREST — The Kingdom Behind the Gates

Document 04 · Locked Canon · History, Geography & Addresses

Founded 1958 by Alexander & Simone Donohue

Location & Address (LOCKED)

Item	Detail
Official name	Belmont Crest (legally The Belmont Crest Association, Inc. , a private gated community)
Main Gate address	One Belmont Crest Parkway NW, Atlanta, Georgia 30327
City / County	Inside the City of Atlanta, Fulton County , Georgia
Neighborhood	Northwest Buckhead , Atlanta's wealthiest district, inside the I-285 Perimeter
Precise location	On the wooded bluffs above the Chattahoochee River , entered from West Paces Ferry Road NW about 1.5 miles west of the Georgia Governor's Mansion. The river forms the community's entire western and northern border.
ZIP code	30327, the most affluent ZIP code in Georgia
Size	1,140 acres
Residences	212 homes, from 8,000 to 60,000+ sq. ft.
Population (2005)	About 780 residents, plus about 1,400 staff who come through the Service Gate daily
Distance	15 minutes to Donohue Tower (Peachtree Road). 20 minutes to Downtown and Midtown. 30 minutes to Hartsfield-Jackson.
Police jurisdiction	APD Zone 2 (Buckhead), plus the community's private security, contracted since 2002 to Blackwater Security International

The Gates

- **The Main Gate (the Crown Gate):** One Belmont Crest Parkway NW, off West Paces Ferry Road. Twin limestone guardhouses, 24-foot wrought-iron gates with a gilded "BC" crown crest, and a scorch mark on the left pillar that has been deliberately preserved since 1959 (see History).
 - **The Service Gate:** Off Paces Ferry Road NW. Staff, deliveries, and contractors.
 - **The River Gate:** A private dock and boathouse on the Chattahoochee. Officially closed after dark. **SECRET:** The birthplace of the Blackwater Syndicate (see Document 06).
-

Neighborhoods Within Belmont Crest

Section	Character	Notable Residents
The Summit (Sovereign Way)	The highest bluff. The Donohue family compound: six estates around a private garden.	Victor & Joan, Simone, Theodore, the Olsons, the Bullocks, Marc-Anthony
Kingsridge (Kingsridge Drive)	Old-money mansions on 5–15 acre lots. Judges, moguls, surgeons, athletes.	The Cummings family
Magnolia Terrace	Smaller but elegant homes (8,000–10,000 sq ft) reserved by charter for professionals: doctors, dentists, educators, clergy.	The Baker family, Bishop Everett Lyons
Riverbend	Newer luxury homes on the Chattahoochee, built 1985–2000	New money, entertainers, executives
The Commons	Village green, chapel, Belmont Crest Academy, market, post office	Community center

Key Addresses (LOCKED)

Address	Residence	Residents
1 Sovereign Way	Donohue Manor. A 1960 Georgian Revival, 48,000 sq ft, 30 acres.	Victor & Joan Donohue
2 Sovereign Way	The Dowager House. A 1958 Creole-style mansion with wraparound galleries, the first house built in Belmont Crest.	Simone Donohue
3 Sovereign Way	Theodore's House ("Ashgrove"). A dark-brick Tudor with a vault underneath.	Theodore & Connie Donohue
9 Sovereign Way	The Olson Estate. Modern limestone, with a surgical suite in the east wing.	Peter, Jasmine, and Mallory Olson (Martin keeps a wing, plus a Midtown loft)
12 Sovereign Way	The Bullock Estate ("Belle Rive"). A Mediterranean palazzo overlooking the river.	Robert & Natasha Bullock, Grace Bullock (who also keeps an L.A. home)
25 Sovereign Way	The Bullock Pavilion. A glass-and-stone contemporary, built 2003.	Marc-Anthony Bullock
31 Sovereign Way	The Carriage House. A renovated guest estate.	Alvin Donohue (when he isn't in Miami)
41 Kingsridge Drive	The Cummings Estate	Franklin & Yvette Cummings, Arianna Cummings
214 Magnolia Terrace	The Baker Home	Dr. Curtis & Gloria Baker, Kiara Baker. Amond keeps his old room but lives in a Buckhead penthouse.
7 Chapel Lane	The Parsonage	Bishop Everett & First Lady Pearl Lyons

Address	Residence	Residents
Elxa & Jeremy	Live outside the gates on purpose, in a Virginia-Highland Craftsman at 1087 Rosedale Road NE, Atlanta 30306. Elxa refuses to "live on the family's dime" as Chief.	Chief Elxa & Det. Jeremy Jackson

Amenities

- **The Belmont Crest Country Club** (see below)
 - **Belmont Crest Chapel:** A white-stone chapel from 1959. Every family wedding and funeral happens here.
 - **Greater Crest Tabernacle:** The community's AME church, led by Bishop Everett Lyons.
 - **Belmont Crest Academy:** A private pre-K through 12 school, founded 1962. Marc-Anthony graduated at 12.
 - **Lake Simone:** A 40-acre spring-fed lake with swans, a gazebo, and a Fourth of July fireworks barge.
 - **The Crest Equestrian Center**, a 30-stall barn and polo field
 - **The River Boathouse & Dock** on the Chattahoochee
 - **The Commons Market**, a gourmet grocery, café, and pharmacy (named Toussaint's, after Simone)
 - A private **helipad** at the Summit
-

THE HISTORY OF BELMONT CREST

1955–1957: The Buckhead Gambit

- In 1955 the U.S. Supreme Court rules in *Holmes v. City of Atlanta* that Atlanta's public golf courses must desegregate. On the first integrated day, a white man spits on Alexander's shoes at the North Fulton course. Alexander goes home and tells Simone: *"I'm done asking to play on their land. We'll buy our own."*
- Black families in 1950s Atlanta are pushed to the south and west side. The real estate industry quietly makes sure no white Buckhead seller will sell to a Black buyer.
- **Simone's plan:**
 - Alexander hires a young white attorney, **Harlan Whitcomb**, who hates the Klan more than he likes money.
 - Through Whitcomb and **eleven shell companies** (named after Simone's favorite flowers: Magnolia Land Co., Camellia Holdings, Jasmine Trust, and so on), the Donohues quietly buy

1,140 acres of Chattahoochee bluff forest from 23 owners over 26 months.

- The sellers think the buyer is a "Northern timber syndicate."

1958: The Founding

- **Saturday, March 15, 1958:** The deeds are consolidated. The **Belmont Crest Association, Inc.** is chartered.
 - The name comes from **Belmont**, Simone's family's plantation-era origin story (her great-grandmother was enslaved on a Louisiana estate called Belmont). **Simone insisted:** *"We will take the name they owned us under and make it mean something they can never touch."*
 - **"Crest"** is for the bluff, and for the family crown.
- **Monday, May 5, 1958:** At a press conference at the Hotel Donohue, **Alexander reveals that the owner of the largest private landholding in Buckhead is a Black man.**
 - The *Atlanta Daily World* runs the headline **"DONOHUE BUYS BUCKHEAD."**
 - White Buckhead panics.
- **Summer 1958:**
 - Groundbreaking on the **Dowager House** (then simply "Simone's House") and the **main gate**.
 - Neighbors petition the city to rezone the land as "unsuitable for residential use."
 - Harlan Whitcomb wins in court.

1959: The Fire at the Gate

- **Saturday, June 20, 1959:** Victor Donohue marries Joan Mercer, the first wedding at Belmont Crest Chapel. 600 guests attend.
- **Saturday, October 24, 1959, 1:15 AM:** Klansmen burn a 12-foot cross at the Crown Gate.
 - **Simone, 48, stands on the Dowager House porch in her nightgown with a shotgun until dawn.**
 - Theodore (25) and Victor (23) guard the gate with rifles beside her.
 - At 7:00 AM, Simone serves the reporters coffee and biscuits and says: ***"Tell them we're not going anywhere. Tell them we're just getting started."***
 - The scorched gate pillar has been preserved ever since. A bronze plaque reads: *"October 24, 1959. We stayed."*

1960s: The Kingdom Builds

- **1960:** Donohue Manor is completed. Victor and Joan move in with newborn Jasmine.
- **Saturday, April 15, 1961: The Belmont Crest Country Club opens.** It is the first Black-owned private country club in the South with a championship course.
- **1962:** Belmont Crest Academy opens.

- **1963:** The **Magnolia Terrace Charter** passes. Simone insists that 40 lots be permanently reserved and sold at cost to Black teachers, doctors, dentists, nurses, and ministers: "*A kingdom with no teachers is just a fortress.*" That's why the Bakers (a dentist and a principal) live there.
- **Throughout the Civil Rights Movement**, Belmont Crest quietly shelters movement leaders, lawyers, and entertainers in Atlanta, behind gates the Klan can't get through.

1970s–1980s: "Black Royalty"

- **1971:** *Ebony* runs a 12-page spread, "**Inside Belmont Crest: America's Black Royalty**," which gives the family its lasting nickname.
- **1974–1988:** Kingsridge and Riverbend fill with Black athletes, entertainers, judges, and executives. A home in Belmont Crest becomes the ultimate status symbol in Black America.
- **1985:** *Lifestyles of the Rich and Famous* is denied entry at the Main Gate. Robin Leach reports from the sidewalk.

1990s–2004: The Modern Era

- **1992:** Belmont Crest Academy's championship debate team, including 10-year-old Marc-Anthony Bullock, wins the national title.
- **1996:** During the Olympics, Belmont Crest hosts a private gala for 40 heads of state.
- **1999:** Alexander dies at Donohue Manor.
- **2002:** Community security is contracted to **Blackwater Security International**, the new company of 20-year-old Marc-Anthony Bullock. Crime inside the gates drops from "almost none" to **exactly none**.
- **2003:** The Bullock Pavilion is built at 25 Sovereign Way.
- **2004:** Elxa Bullock marries Jeremy Jackson at the Chapel on **October 16**.

THE BELMONT CREST COUNTRY CLUB

Item	Detail
Opened	Saturday, April 15, 1961
Clubhouse	A 110,000 sq ft Georgian clubhouse overlooking the 18th green and the river
Golf	The Sovereign Course , an 18-hole championship course, par 72, 7,420 yards. Home of the Crest Classic charity tournament every October.
Other	The Simone Ballroom (seats 900), the Alexander Grill, the Toussaint Spa, 16 tennis courts (clay and grass), an Olympic pool, and the Cigar Library
Membership	By invitation only. Initiation fee: \$500,000 (2005). Maximum 400 member families. The waiting list is 11 years long.

Item	Detail
General Manager	Percival "Percy" Langston (see Document 07)
Club President	Victor Donohue (honorary). Board chaired by Franklin Cummings.

Club Traditions (Recurring Story Events)

Event	When (2005)	Purpose
The New Year's Crown Brunch	Sunday, January 2, 2005 (the day before the premiere)	The season opener
The Founders' Ball	Saturday, March 12, 2005 (the weekend before Alexander's birthday)	Black-tie, February-sweeps aftermath
The Magnolia Cotillion	Saturday, April 30, 2005	Debutantes presented. May sweeps event.
The Juneteenth Lawn Party	Sunday, June 19, 2005	Lawn party, fireworks. Harmony's birthday.
The Fourth on the Lake	Monday, July 4, 2005	Fireworks barge on Lake Simone
The Crest Classic	Oct. 13–16, 2005	Charity golf, a November-sweeps lead-in
The Queen's Jubilee (Simone at 95)	Wednesday, November 2, 2005	Simone's 95th birthday, the November sweeps showpiece
The Christmas Crown Gala	Saturday, December 17, 2005	White-tie holiday ball

Club Rules Everybody Breaks

1. No business on the course. (Everyone does business on the course.)
2. No cell phones in the Alexander Grill. (Alvin has had four phones confiscated.)
3. Guests must be accompanied by a member. (**Esther Smiley will get in without one.**)

Life Behind the Gates: Tone Notes for Writers

- Belmont Crest is paradise with sharp edges: manicured, silent, and watching.
- Security logs every entry. **BSI controls the security logs.** That matters.
- Staff see everything. The housekeepers' and drivers' network is the fastest gossip system in Atlanta.
- The Smilleys' estate, **Ravenhurst**, sits **just outside** the gates, across the Nancy Creek ravine off West Paces Ferry Road, bordering Belmont Crest's eastern wall (see Document 05). The two families can see each other's lights at night.

THE SMILLEYS & SMILLEY INTERNATIONAL

Document 05 · Locked Canon · The Secondary Family, Their Empire & the Feud

Family motto: "The Smile Is Ours."

Who They Are

The Smilleys are **Chicago's Black royalty**. The Donohues are Southern old money: land, faith, legacy. The Smilleys are Northern new money turned old: **glamour, jazz, fashion, and velvet cruelty**. The Donohues build kingdoms. The Smilleys build **brands**.

They are the **second-wealthiest family in the world** and the Donohues' **fiercest rivals and competitors**. The two families have been at war since the **Savannah Betrayal of March 7, 1952** (see Document 03). In **January 2005**, the Smilleys move their headquarters from Chicago to Atlanta, into Donohue territory.

Item	Detail
Family fortune	About \$640 billion (second in the world)
Company	Smilley International, Inc. (privately held)
Valuation	About \$1.9 trillion
Atlanta estate	Ravenhurst , 4 Ravenhurst Lane NW, Atlanta, GA 30327. A 1920s French château bought in 2004 on 90 acres just east of Belmont Crest's wall.
Chicago estate	Hart House , 4900 S. Greenwood Ave., Kenwood, Chicago (still owned; Odessa's favorite)

SMILLEY FAMILY TREE (Ages as of Monday, January 3, 2005)

- **Cornelius Smilley** (1908–1987) + **Odessa Hart Smilley** (84)
 - **Lucius Smilley** (55) + **Vivienne Beaumont Smilley** (49)
 - **Lucius "Luke" Smilley Jr.** (28) + **Noelle Smilley** (26)
 - **Delphine Smilley-Ashe** (25) + **Gideon Ashe** (29)
 - **Esther Smilley** (22)
 - **Emma Smilley** (2) and **Victoria Smilley** (2), secretly fathered by Marc-Anthony Bullock
 - **Desmond Smilley** (48), divorced
 - **Quentin Smilley** (21)
-

THE FOUNDER

Cornelius Augustus Smilley (Deceased)

- **Born:** Saturday, August 8, 1908, Vicksburg, Mississippi · **Died:** Thursday, February 19, 1987, Chicago (aged 78)
 - Left Mississippi in 1925 during the Great Migration. Worked as a **Pullman porter from 1926 to 1937** and was a proud member of the Brotherhood of Sleeping Car Porters.
 - Pullman porters were forced to answer to "George" and to smile for tips. Cornelius smiled for eleven years. **The family name was originally "Smiley."** He added the second "L" in 1938 when he opened his first hotel: *"They made me smile for them. Now they'll pay to see me smile, and they'll spell it my way."*
 - A brilliant showman who treated **hotels as theater**. Doormen in white gloves, a jazz orchestra every night, and fresh roses in every room.
 - **His wound:** The Savannah Betrayal (1952). He died believing Alexander Donohue robbed him.
 - **Died** of a heart attack the day after the Donohue Chicago opened directly across from his flagship. The Smilleys call it murder by hotel.
-

THE FAMILY

Odessa Hart Smilley — The Dowager Empress

- **Born:** January 24, 1920, Chicago (Bronzeville) · **Age:** 84 (turns 85 on Monday, January 24, 2005) · **Looks:** mid-60s
- A former torch singer at the Regal Theater and the Smilley Hotel's supper club, the Crystal Room. She married Cornelius in 1946. He was 37 and she was 26.
- **Simone Donohue's nemesis.** The two queens met exactly once, at a 1963 NAACP gala. Their 90-second conversation is still discussed in Chicago and Atlanta.
- She's convinced Simone holds proof of what really happened in Savannah. **She's right.**
- Named Esther's middle name ("Odessa"). **She suggested "Simone" as Victoria's middle name**, saying it was after "a French jazz singer I once loved." It was really a private dig at her rival. She has no idea the baby is Simone's great-great-granddaughter.
- **Voice:** Gravelly, grand, cruel. *"Simone Donohue has been ninety years old since 1950."*

Lucius Cornelius Smilley — The Chairman

- **Born:** November 30, 1949 · **Age:** 55 · **Looks:** early 40s
- Howard University '71, University of Chicago MBA '74. **Chairman & CEO of Smilley International (1987–present).**

- Charming, cultured, and vindictive. He grew Smilley International from \$40 billion to \$1.9 trillion. He has hated the Donohues since he was two years old, because he was raised to.
- **Moving the headquarters to Atlanta** is his life's crusade: *"Daddy died looking at their hotel. I'll die looking at their grave."*
- **Named Esther his heir** on her 21st birthday (**Saturday, September 20, 2003**) at the Smilley Harlem gala, passing over Luke and Delphine. Luke threw a champagne glass at the ice sculpture.
- **SECRET:** Lucius was diagnosed with **early-onset Parkinson's disease** in 2003. Only his neurologist and Vivienne know. It's why he rushed the succession, and he hides a tremor behind a cane he claims is "for style."
- **SECRET:** He has long suspected that Luke is not his biological son.
- **Voice:** Velvet baritone, literary, poisonous. *"We don't lose to the Donohues. We allow them to finish second, graciously, for now."*

Vivienne Beaumont Smilley — The Brand

- **Born:** March 17, 1955, Washington, D.C. (the Gold Coast neighborhood) · **Age:** 49 · **Looks:** mid-30s
- A former **Ebony Fashion Fair** runway model, and the first Black woman to front a major French perfume campaign (1976).
- **Chief Brand Officer, Smilley International.** She created the **Smile** fragrance, the **Odessa** couture line, and **Hart Home**.
- An icy perfectionist who loves her children in order of usefulness.
- **SECRET: Luke is Desmond's son.** It came from a two-month affair with her brother-in-law in the spring of 1975. Desmond knows. Lucius suspects. Luke has no idea.
- **Voice:** Cool, elegant, surgical. *"Darling, I don't dislike you. I simply don't see you."*

Desmond Hart Smilley — The Snake

- **Born:** August 21, 1956 · **Age:** 48 · **Looks:** late 30s
- Lucius's younger brother. **Vice Chairman, Smilley International.** He runs the real estate division, **Smilley Estates**.
- Divorced (twice). Father of Quentin. **Secretly Luke's biological father.**
- Has resented being the "spare" his whole life. He plans to use Luke's claim, and then reveal Luke's true paternity, to push Esther out and seize the company.
- **SECRET:** He is in secret talks with **Martin Olson**, an enemy inside the enemy's house. Their deal: help each other remove the two heirs, Esther and Marc-Anthony.
- **Voice:** Easy laugh, dead eyes. *"Family is everything. That's why I keep a copy of everyone's."*

Lucius "Luke" Smilley Jr. — The Dethroned Prince

- **Born:** February 2, 1976 · **Age:** 28 · **Looks:** mid-20s

- Eldest child. Morehouse '98 (the Smilleys chose Atlanta for college as a statement), Harvard MBA '02.
- **President, Smilley Hotels & Resorts.** He's genuinely good at hotels.
- He was raised as the heir until 2003, and has been **humiliated and furious** ever since.
- **Married:** Noelle Price, May 26, 2001. They've been through years of failed fertility treatments, which makes Esther's "IVF twins" feel like a daily insult.
- **Doesn't know Desmond is his biological father.**
- **Voice:** Loud, entitled, wounded. *"I did everything right. She did everything first."*

Noelle Price Smilley — The Social Climber

- **Born:** June 1, 1978, Milwaukee · **Age:** 26 · **Looks:** early 20s
- Former **Miss Black Wisconsin (1998)** and a Chicago TV weather anchor. Luke's wife.
- Desperate for a baby, a title, and a seat at the Belmont Crest Country Club. **She'd betray the Smilleys in a heartbeat for the Donohues' approval.**
- **Voice:** Sweet as pie and twice as fattening. *"I'm not jealous, I'm just paying attention."*

Delphine Smilley-Ashe — The Ice Queen

- **Born:** October 5, 1979 · **Age:** 25 · **Looks:** early 20s
- Middle child. Parsons School of Design '01. **President, Maison Smilley**, the luxury department stores and lifestyle brands.
- A fashion icon and a *Vogue* favorite, with a taste for elegant revenge. She hates Esther with style.
- **Married:** **Gideon Ashe**, June 21, 2003, at the Smilley Harlem.
- **Voice:** Clipped, bored, lethal. *"Esther got Daddy's company. I got his taste. We'll see which lasts."*

Gideon Ashe — The Gambler

- **Born:** July 18, 1975, New York · **Age:** 29 · **Looks:** mid-20s
- Founder of **Ashe Capital**, a hedge fund. He's handsome and smooth, and he's lying about everything.
- **SECRET:** The fund is collapsing, and Gideon owes **\$212 million** to underground high-stakes card games. **Those games are run by the Blackwater Syndicate.** Sovereign holds the Smilley son-in-law's marker, and Marc doesn't yet realize what leverage he has.
- **Voice:** Easy confidence, constant sweating. *"It's a liquidity event, not a problem."*

Esther Odessa Smilley — The Heiress

(Full profile in Document 02.)

- **Age: 22. Designated heir. President, Smilley International Atlanta.** She personally runs the move to Atlanta.
- **Her masterstroke:** In 2002 she began building a 72-story tower in Buckhead under a shell company called **Peachtree Pinnacle Partners**. Nobody knew who owned it until the December 2004 announcement. **It was the same trick Alexander Donohue used to buy Belmont Crest in 1955.** Victor noticed. Simone laughed out loud.
- **Mother of Emma and Victoria** ("the IVF twins").

Quentin Hart Smilley — The Wild Card

- **Born:** November 11, 1983 · **Age:** 21 · **Looks:** late teens
- Desmond's only child. He dropped out of Northwestern and is a DJ and club promoter who plans to "go to Atlanta and run the city."
- **Alvin Donohue's new best friend** in the club scene. **Mallory Olson's forbidden attraction.** He's sweeter than he pretends to be, and far less stupid.
- He has no idea he's his father's pawn.
- **Voice:** Charming, clowning, and secretly lonely. *"I'm not the black sheep. I'm the sheep that brought the party."*

Emma & Victoria Smilley — "The IVF Twins"

(Full profiles in Document 02.) Both are 2. Their nanny is **Beatrix Pennington** (Document 07). The Smilleys adore them. Their grandfather Lucius calls them "my dividends." **Nobody in the family knows whose they are.**

THE HISTORY OF SMILLEY INTERNATIONAL

Year	Milestone
1938	Cornelius opens The Smilley , a 90-room hotel on South Parkway in Bronzeville, with the Crystal Room supper club. Nat King Cole, Billie Holiday, and Count Basie perform there.
1941–1951	Green Book expansion across the North and Midwest: The Smilley Harlem (1946), Detroit, Cleveland, St. Louis, Kansas City, and Pittsburgh. Plus a lakeside resort at Idlewild, Michigan , the "Black Eden."
March 7, 1952	The Savannah Betrayal. The Donohue-Smilley merger collapses.
1953–1960	Smilley Realty is founded. During the era of predatory "contract buying," it builds and finances fair-mortgage apartment buildings for Black Chicagoans, and becomes Chicago's largest Black landlord.
1962	Smilley Resorts opens at Oak Bluffs, Martha's Vineyard and in Montego Bay, Jamaica.

Year	Milestone
1968	South Parkway is renamed Martin Luther King Drive. Cornelius keeps the flagship's lights on for 30 straight days in mourning.
1974–1979	Smilley Resorts expands to Barbados, Nassau, and the Riviera. The Smilley at Lake Shore , a 60-story luxury condominium tower, opens on Chicago's Gold Coast in 1979.
1983	Maison Smilley , the first Black-owned luxury department store on the Magnificent Mile, opens at 900 N. Michigan Avenue.
Wednesday, February 18, 1987	Donohue Chicago opens directly across from The Smilley.
Thursday, February 19, 1987	Cornelius dies of a heart attack the next morning. Lucius, 37, becomes Chairman & CEO.
1989	The company is renamed Smilley International, Inc. , and goes global with hotels in London (Mayfair), Paris, Dubai, and Monaco.
1990s	Lifestyle brands: Smile fragrance (1991), <i>Odessa</i> couture (1994), Hart Home (1997). Maison Smilley flagships open in New York, Beverly Hills, London, Paris, and Tokyo.
2001	Smilley Estates builds branded luxury residences in 20 cities.
September 20, 2003	Esther is named heir.
2002–2004	"Peachtree Pinnacle Partners" secretly builds a 72-story tower in Buckhead.
Thursday, December 9, 2004	The Announcement: Smilley International will move its world headquarters to Smilley Tower, 3434 Peachtree Road NE, Atlanta, GA 30326 , directly across Peachtree Road from Donohue Tower.
Monday, January 3, 2005	Smilley Tower officially opens on the morning of the series premiere.

Smilley International — Structure (2005)

Division	Business	Leader
Smilley Hotels & Resorts	1,400 luxury hotels and resorts in 90 countries. Brands: The Smilley, Crystal Room Hotels, Idlewild Resorts.	Luke Smilley
Smilley Estates	Luxury real estate, branded residences, commercial towers	Desmond Smilley
Maison Smilley	Luxury department stores (48 flagships), high-end retail	Delphine Smilley-Ashe
Smilley Lifestyle	Smile fragrance, <i>Odessa</i> couture, Hart Home, cosmetics, jewelry	Vivienne Smilley
Smilley Private Clubs	Members-only clubs in 20 cities	Lucius (direct)

Division	Business	Leader
Smilley International Atlanta	The new headquarters operation and the Southern expansion	Esther Smilley

- **Employees:** About 610,000 · **Countries:** 90 · **Flagship:** The Smilley, Chicago · **HQ (2005):** Smilley Tower, Atlanta
- **The Smilley Fund:** The family charity. It's generous, but **always with a press release**, a pointed contrast with the Donohues' "spare no expense, sign no name."

THE FEUD — Rules of Engagement

1. **Every Donohue opening gets a Smilley counter-opening**, usually within the same month.
 2. **Neither family has attended the other's funeral since 1952.**
 3. Hospitality is the main battlefield: Donohue Hospitality Group vs. Smilley Hotels & Resorts. Natasha vs. Luke. Natasha vs. Esther.
 4. **2005 battlegrounds:**
 - The **Atlanta skyline** (the rival towers)
 - The **Belmont Crest Country Club** (Noelle wants in)
 - **Harmony's brokerage** (Esther steers Smilley deals to her best friend)
 - **The Olympic-sized fight over the "Auburn Avenue Revival" redevelopment bid.** Whoever wins it rebuilds the street where Alexander started.
 5. **Hidden alliances:** Martin + Desmond. Noelle + anyone. Gideon and his debt to Blackwater. Mallory + Quentin.
-

Smilley Secrets Ledger

Secret	Who Knows
The twins are Marc-Anthony Bullock's	Esther only
Luke is Desmond's son	Vivienne, Desmond. Lucius suspects.
Lucius has Parkinson's	Lucius, Vivienne
Desmond is allied with Martin Olson	Desmond, Martin
Gideon owes \$212M to Blackwater games	Gideon, the Blackwater Syndicate
Odessa's "Simone" middle-name dig	Odessa
The Savannah Letter exists	Simone has it. Odessa suspects it.

THE BLACKWATER SYNDICATE & BLACKWATER SECURITY INTERNATIONAL

Document 06 · Locked Canon · MAXIMUM SECRECY

"Still water runs deep. Black water runs deepest."

Writers' Note — Two Faces of One Empire

	The Blackwater Syndicate	Blackwater Security International (BSI)
What	A criminal organization	A multinational private security and risk-management corporation
Founded	Friday, September 29, 2000 (secretly)	Tuesday, April 16, 2002 (publicly)
Founder	"Sovereign" (secretly Marc-Anthony Bullock , then 18)	Marc-Anthony Bullock , Founder, Chairman & CEO (then 20)
Status	The largest, most successful, powerful, influential, respected, beloved, feared, dangerous, deadly, charitable, and valuable criminal organization in the world	One of the largest, most successful, powerful, influential, respected, beloved, feared, and valuable companies in the world
Public knowledge	Known to exist. Its leader's identity is unknown .	Everyone knows it, and it's on every magazine cover.
The link	Secret . BSI is both a real, legitimate giant and the Syndicate's perfect shield.	

Continuity convention: In the *Beyond the Kingdom* universe, there is no real-world company called "Blackwater USA." The name "Blackwater" belongs only to Marc-Anthony's empire.

PART ONE — THE BLACKWATER SYNDICATE

The Origin: The Night of July 15, 2000

- **Saturday, July 15, 2000, about 11:50 PM. Grace Bullock, 16**, sneaks out to a "summer white party" at a rented mansion off Habersham Road in Buckhead. It's thrown by a nightclub promoter named **Vaughn "Silk" Harlow**.
- Harlow's crew runs a **trafficking ring** that targets young women at parties. Grace is drugged.

- **Marc-Anthony (18) and Amond (18)** have followed her there because Marc had "a feeling." At **12:40 AM** they find her half-conscious, being carried toward a black Suburban by two men.
 - What happens next takes **four minutes**. Both men are hospitalized. Amond drives Grace to Piedmont Hospital. Marc stays behind.
- **The betrayal of the system:**
 - Harlow is protected by **APD Sergeant Dale Pruitt**, who is on his payroll, and by a **Fulton County commissioner** who is his silent partner.
 - The toxicology report is "lost." The case is **closed by August 22, 2000**.
 - Even Robert Bullock's connections can't reopen it. Robert tells his son: ***"Sometimes the system just loses, son."***
 - Marc answers: ***"Then I'll build a new one."***

The Founding: The River Gate, September 29, 2000

- **Friday, September 29, 2000, 11:59 PM**, at the **River Gate boathouse** on the Chattahoochee below Belmont Crest.
- Present: **Marc-Anthony Bullock (18), Amond Baker (18), and Rashad "Saint" Mayfield (19)**, son of the Bullocks' longtime driver, who grew up on the estate alongside Marc.
- **The name:**
 - When Marc was a boy, Great-Grandfather Alexander brought him to this same dock and told him: *"At night the river looks black. People are scared of it. But it's the same water that carried our people north, that baptized them, and that hid them. Still water runs deep, boy. Black water runs deepest."*
 - Marc took the name from the river.
- **The first act:** Marc sets a polished **black onyx coin** on the dock, engraved with a **crown above a wave**. It becomes the Syndicate's mark: **the Onyx Coin**.
- **The first oath:** *"Nobody touches the innocent. Nobody touches the family. And nobody ever sees my face."*

The First War: Dismantling the Harlow Ring (October–December 2000)

- Over 11 weeks, the Harlow ring falls apart:
 - **Fourteen young women** are found and brought home, with their families' bills paid anonymously.
 - Sergeant Pruitt resigns in disgrace in November 2000 after anonymous evidence reaches Internal Affairs and the newspapers.
 - The commissioner is indicted in December 2000.

- Vaughn "Silk" Harlow and three of his lieutenants are never seen again. Each of their empty apartments has an Onyx Coin on the kitchen table.
- The streets start whispering a name: "**Sovereign**."

Growth (2001–2004)

Date	Event
Early 2001	Recruitment of the core. The Syndicate takes over the ring's former territory and its illegal gambling operations and "cleans" them: no predators, no minors, no drugs sold to kids.
Spring 2001	Tobias Okafor , a 21-year-old MIT dropout, joins as "The Ledger." Keisha Lattimore ("Ghost"), a hacker, is recruited after she breaks into Harvard's systems to change Marc's parking tickets as a job application.
Summer 2001	Roman Gaines , a decorated Army Ranger discharged for striking an officer who used a slur, joins as "The Hammer." Dolores "Mama Dee" Whitfield joins as "The Tithe" after Sovereign finds her grandson's killer.
Tuesday, January 1, 2002, ~2:40 AM	Marc covers up Arianna Cummings' fatal accident (see Document 02). The Syndicate learns it can make anything disappear.
Tuesday, April 16, 2002	BSI is founded.
2002–2003	Expansion across the Southeast, then nationally: Atlanta, Miami, Houston, New Orleans, Charlotte, D.C., New York, Chicago, Los Angeles.
Friday, March 14, 2003	The Nassau Accord. On Alexander's birthday, Sovereign meets through intermediaries with criminal organizations from the Caribbean, London, Lagos, Rotterdam, and Marseille in a Nassau villa. They all agree to Blackwater's terms, rules, and cut. The Syndicate goes global.
Summer 2004	"The Summer of Silence." A war with Silas " The Undertaker " Merriweather , Atlanta's old-school kingpin (Document 07), over Southside territory. Eleven Merriweather properties burn. Nobody talks.
Saturday, August 14, 2004	The Sweet Auburn Truce. Amond and Silas meet at a table in the back of Mama Dee's restaurant. Silas keeps his funeral homes and his pride. Blackwater keeps everything else.
Monday, November 15, 2004	The FBI Atlanta Field Office opens " Operation Deep Water ," led by Special Agent Kathleen Doyle (Document 07).
Monday, December 20, 2004	At her swearing-in, Chief Elxa Jackson announces the APD Blackwater Task Force and promises: " <i>Whoever Sovereign is, I will find him, and I will put him in a cell.</i> " Her brother is in the second row. He applauds louder than anyone.

Structure of the Syndicate (2005)

SOVEREIGN

- **Marc-Anthony Bullock.** Absolute authority. Known in person only to The Seven (and to Arianna Cummings, who is not a member).
- To everyone else, Sovereign is a voice on a secure line, a handwritten note in green ink, or an Onyx Coin.

THE SEVEN ("The Table")

Seat	Title	Member	Age (1/3/05)	Public Cover
1	Sovereign	Marc-Anthony Bullock	22	Chairman & CEO, BSI
2	The Right Hand (Underboss)	Amond Baker	22	SVP of Strategic Operations, BSI
3	The Ledger (Finance)	Tobias Okafor	24	Chief Financial Officer, BSI
4	The Ghost (Intelligence & Archive)	Keisha Lattimore	25	Director of Cyber & Information Assurance, BSI
5	The Hammer (Enforcement & Operations)	Roman Gaines	28	Director of Global Operations, BSI
6	The Tithe (Charity & Community)	Dolores "Mama Dee" Whitfield	53	Owner, Dee's Kitchen (West End)
7	The Saint (Streets & Territory)	Rashad "Saint" Mayfield	23	BSI Community Liaison / owner of Saint's Car Wash chain

THE EIGHTH CHAIR

- An **eighth chair** stands at the Table, and **it's always empty**.
- When asked, Sovereign says only: ***"It's for someone I haven't met yet."***
- (*Writers' foreshadowing: the Queen's Chair.*)

THE HOUSES (Operational Divisions)

House	Run By	Activity (kept deliberately general on screen)
The Parlors	Saint & Ledger	Invitation-only, high-stakes underground gambling in 30 cities. Gideon Ashe owes the Parlors \$212 million.

House	Run By	Activity (kept deliberately general on screen)
The Harbor	Hammer	Smuggling of contraband cargo and untaxed luxury goods through ports worldwide
The Archive	Ghost	Intelligence brokering. The Syndicate holds files on corrupt politicians, judges, CEOs, and police, and uses them.
The Ledger	Ledger	Moves and cleans money for the Syndicate and its allies through shell companies worldwide
The Shield	Right Hand	"Protection" of businesses the Syndicate controls, and political fixing
The Hunt	Hammer & Ghost	Tracking and destroying predators, traffickers, and anyone who breaks the Code
The Tithe	Mama Dee	The Syndicate's charitable arm

Scale (2005)

- **Members:** An estimated 40,000 worldwide across all affiliates. Only about 300 have ever spoken directly with one of The Seven.
- **Revenue:** The FBI estimates more than \$60 billion a year. **The true figure is more than triple that.**
- **Reach:** Present in 58 countries through the Nassau Accord.

THE BLACKWATER CODE (The Ten Laws)

1. **Nobody touches a child. Ever.**
2. **No trafficking in human beings.** We hunt those who do.
3. **No poison on our own streets.** We don't sell hard drugs in our communities.
4. **Women, elders, and the innocent are off-limits.**
5. **Loyalty is paid in full. Betrayal is paid in full.**
6. **Nobody sees Sovereign's face** except The Seven.
7. **The Tithe:** A share of every dollar goes back to the people.
8. **Don't bring heat home.**
9. **Clean cops are left alone. Dirty cops belong to us.**
10. **Family is sacred.** Every member's family is under Blackwater protection, for life.

Breaking Laws 1 or 2 is the only unforgivable sin. The penalty is spoken of only as "the river."

THE TITHE — "Spare No Expense"

The Syndicate is the most charitable criminal organization in history. The Tithe:

- **Pays off medical debt** for entire hospital wards, anonymously. The receipts arrive with an Onyx Coin.
- **"Blackwater Christmas"**: Every December 24 since 2000, toys, turkeys, and \$500 envelopes appear on the doorsteps of 20,000+ families in Atlanta's poorest neighborhoods.
- **The Envelope Scholarships**: Full tuition, delivered in cash-funded trusts, to kids nobody else invests in.
- Funds **women's shelters**, funeral costs, and back rent. After the Summer of Silence, it rebuilt every Southside house that burned by accident.
- **The result**: In parts of Atlanta, **Sovereign is a folk hero**. Kids spray-paint the crown and wave on walls. Grandmothers pray for him by name. *"Who is Sovereign?"* is the city's favorite question.

The Onyx Coin

- A black onyx coin with a **crown over a wave**.
- **Left at a scene**: Blackwater did this.
- **Given to a person**: That person is **under Blackwater protection**. Anyone who touches them answers to Sovereign.
- **Mama Dee carries the first 1,000 ever made**.

PART TWO — BLACKWATER SECURITY INTERNATIONAL (BSI)

At a Glance (January 2005)

Item	Detail
Legal name	Blackwater Security International, Inc. (BSI)
Type	Privately held multinational private security and risk-management corporation
Founded	Tuesday, April 16, 2002 , Atlanta
Founder, Chairman & CEO	Marc-Anthony Bullock
President & COO	Lt. Gen. Walter Bassett, U.S. Army (Ret.)
Headquarters	BSI Tower, 1 Blackwater Plaza, Midtown, Atlanta, GA 30309 . 58 stories of black glass. Marc's penthouse is on the 58th floor.

Item	Detail
Training campus	The Sumter Center. 9,000 acres in Sumter County, Georgia, near Alexander Donohue's birthplace.
Employees	About 118,000 in 64 countries
2004 revenue	\$31 billion
Valuation	About \$210 billion , one of the most valuable private companies on Earth, built in under three years
Tagline	<i>"Nothing touches what we protect."</i>

The Founding Story (Official Version)

- After September 11, 2001, 19-year-old Harvard J.D./M.B.A. graduate Marc-Anthony Bullock saw that **the world had become unsafe, and the security industry hadn't caught up.**
- He founded BSI on **April 16, 2002** with **\$3 billion from his personal trust** and a first contract from Donohue Global Holdings.
- **Within 12 months** BSI had won port-security contracts in 11 countries, protection for 200 Fortune 500 executives, and the security contract for Belmont Crest. *Fortune* called it "the fastest-growing company in history."

BSI Divisions

Division	Services
BSI Executive Protection	Bodyguards for heads of state, CEOs, celebrities, and athletes
BSI Risk & Intelligence	Corporate intelligence, due diligence, political-risk analysis, investigations
BSI Maritime & Ports	Port and shipping security, anti-piracy
BSI Aviation	Airport and private aviation security, armored aviation
BSI Cyber & Information Assurance	Network security, data protection (advanced for 2005)
BSI Armored Logistics	Armored transport of cash, art, jewels, and sensitive cargo
BSI Crisis Response	Kidnap-and-ransom response, evacuations, disaster rescue
BSI Communities	Security for gated communities, campuses, stadiums, and events
The Sumter Center	Training academy for BSI, police departments, and allied governments

Why BSI Is Respected, Beloved, and Feared

- **Respected:** Flawless record. No protected client has ever been harmed.
- **Beloved:** BSI Crisis Response teams show up **free** at disasters: floods, fires, tornadoes. Every BSI job pays at least 40% above industry rates, with full college tuition for employees' kids. BSI hires

veterans and people with records who have served their time: *"Everybody deserves a second shot. Nobody gets a third."*

- **Feared:** Competitors lose contracts overnight. Journalists who dig too deep find their sources gone quiet. And everyone notices that **crime drops wherever BSI shows up.**

BSI Leadership

Title	Name	Knows About the Syndicate?
Founder, Chairman & CEO	Marc-Anthony Bullock	He IS Sovereign
President & COO	Lt. Gen. (Ret.) Walter Bassett	No. An honorable soldier. His discovery would be a major future arc.
CFO	Tobias Okafor	Yes (The Ledger)
SVP, Strategic Operations	Amond Baker	Yes (The Right Hand)
Director, Global Operations	Roman Gaines	Yes (The Hammer)
Director, Cyber & Information Assurance	Keisha Lattimore	Yes (The Ghost)
Executive Assistant to the CEO	Brielle Sutton	No, but she suspects. Fiercely loyal.

Who's Hunting Sovereign (2005)

Hunter	Motive	Knows It's Marc?
Chief Elxa Jackson , APD Blackwater Task Force	Justice. The book. Her reputation.	No
Det. Jeremy Jackson , APD Homicide	The Harlow disappearances (a cold case)	No, but he's the first to notice patterns around the Bullocks
SA Kathleen Doyle & SA Daniel Reyes , FBI "Operation Deep Water"	A career-making federal case	No
Martin Olson	Destroy Sovereign, then use the Disgrace Clause	No, and when he finds out, it's war
Silas Merriweather	Revenge for the Summer of Silence	No
Desmond Smilley	Leverage	No

Future Arc Seeds (Writers Only)

1. **Hurricane Katrina (Monday, August 29, 2005)** is Elxa's 25th birthday. BSI Crisis Response and the Syndicate's Tithe mobilize massively in New Orleans, Simone's hometown. BSI rescues thousands, and Sovereign becomes a national legend.
2. **The Eighth Chair** is waiting for Esther.
3. **Gideon's marker** gives Blackwater a hidden hand inside the Smilley family.

4. **Grace's night** is the Syndicate's origin, and the reason she'd hide a body for her brother.
5. **Harmony's missing brother** is a Blackwater secret that could destroy Marc, Amond, and Arianna at once.

BEYOND THE KINGDOM — Supporting Cast

Document 07 · Locked Canon · The World Around the Kingdom

All ages exact as of Monday, January 3, 2005. Unless noted, every character is African American. Non-Black characters are marked †. They're the few the premise calls for.

THE DONOHUE ORBIT

Constance "Connie" Pryor Donohue — *The Trophy With Teeth*

- **Born:** August 14, 1966 · **Age:** 38 · **Looks:** late 20s
- Theodore's third wife, married 1998. She was a Delta flight attendant who met Theodore in first class.
- The family calls her a gold digger. She calls herself "a diversified portfolio."
- **SECRET:** She secretly writes "**CrestWatch**," the anonymous gossip blog that has leaked Belmont Crest secrets since 2003. The whole city reads it, and nobody suspects the woman who always seems bored at dinner.
- **Voice:** *"Honey, I didn't marry for money. I married for access. Money was just parked outside."*

Reginald Donohue — *The Forgotten Son*

- **Born:** September 9, 1957 · **Age:** 47 · **Looks:** late 30s
- Theodore's only son, from his first marriage. He was a Georgia State Senator until he resigned in 1999 over a land-deal scandal. Theodore made that scandal go away quietly.
- Now **President of Donohue Realty**. Victor gave him the job as a peace offering, and Reginald treats it like an insult.
- Divorced, bitter, and drinking. He knows where some of his father's vault files are buried.
- **Voice:** *"My father was passed over. I was passed under."*

Winston Fairley — *The Butler*

- **Born:** October 10, 1942, Kingston, Jamaica · **Age:** 62 · **Looks:** late 40s
- **Head of Household, Donohue Manor, since 1968.** He was trained at London's Savoy.
- He knows every secret in the Manor and will die before repeating one. Marc was the one who organized the staff's 1994 pay strike, and Winston has been his quiet ally ever since.
- **Voice:** *"Sir, I don't listen at doors. Doors simply speak to me."*

Ruby Mae Tolliver — *"Nana Ruby"*

- **Born:** December 25, 1938, Americus, Georgia · **Age:** 66 · **Looks:** mid-50s
 - **Housekeeper at Belle Rive (the Bullock estate) since 1980.** She raised Elxa, Marc, and Grace as much as Natasha did.
 - Marc loves her like a grandmother. **Anyone who hurts Nana Ruby meets the monster.**
 - She's from Americus, like Alexander. She knew the Donohue name before it was famous.
 - **Voice:** *"Baby, I changed your diapers. Don't you dare 'Miss Tolliver' me."*
-

BELMONT CREST FIXTURES

Percival "Percy" Langston — The Gatekeeper

- **Born:** May 5, 1949 · **Age:** 55 · **Looks:** early 40s
- **General Manager, Belmont Crest Country Club** since 1984. He guards the club's etiquette like scripture and its waiting list like Fort Knox.
- He loves the old guard and fears new money. Esther Smalley will be his worst nightmare.
- **Voice:** *"Membership is not purchased, madam. It is bestowed."*

Bishop Everett Lyons — The Shepherd

- **Born:** April 1, 1944 · **Age:** 60 · **Looks:** late 40s
- **Senior Pastor, Greater Crest Tabernacle AME,** since 1979. A civil-rights-era preacher and the Donohues' spiritual adviser.
- He baptized Marc, married Elxa, and hears confessions he shouldn't have to keep.
- **Voice:** *"God forgives. Belmont Crest keeps minutes."*

First Lady Pearl Lyons

- **Born:** August 30, 1947 · **Age:** 57 · **Looks:** mid-40s
 - She runs the church, the Magnolia Cotillion, and every piece of gossip that goes through the choir loft.
 - **Voice:** *"I'm not gossiping. I'm putting it on the prayer list."*
-

THE BAKER FAMILY (Magnolia Terrace, upper middle class)

Dr. Curtis Baker — The Dentist

- **Born:** January 19, 1954 · **Age:** 50 · **Looks:** early 40s

- Meharry Medical College DDS. Owns **Baker Family Dentistry** in Buckhead.
- A proud, decent, by-the-book man. He wants Amond to be "respectable." **He has no idea his son is the underboss of the Blackwater Syndicate.**
- **Voice:** *"Son, a man is only as good as his name, and ours is clean."*

Gloria Baker — The Principal

- **Born:** May 3, 1956 · **Age:** 48 · **Looks:** late 30s
- **Principal of Frederick Douglass High School** (Atlanta Public Schools). She's tough love incarnate. She adores Lyric and quietly resents that Harmony keeps her granddaughter at arm's length.
- **Voice:** *"I've expelled better liars than you before first period."*

Kiara Baker — The Little Sister

- **Born:** March 11, 1989 · **Age:** 15 · **Looks:** 15
- Amond's little sister and a sophomore at Belmont Crest Academy. She's a hacker in training who idolizes "Uncle" Marc and is way too curious about Amond's late nights.
- **Voice:** *"I'm not snooping. I'm doing investigative journalism."*

THE CUMMINGS FAMILY (Kingsridge, upper class)

Franklin Cummings — The Mogul

- **Born:** June 27, 1950 · **Age:** 54 · **Looks:** early 40s
- **Chairman, Cummings Media Group**, with 60 radio stations across the South. He's a Donohue Media board member and chairman of the Country Club board.
- He's grooming Arianna for Attorney General, then Governor. He'd sell his soul for her success, and he has sold a few pieces already.
- **Voice:** *"In this state, you're either on the radio or you're being talked about on it."*

Dr. Yvette Cummings — The Cardiologist

- **Born:** December 9, 1953 · **Age:** 51 · **Looks:** late 30s
- **Chief of Cardiology, Atlanta Presbyterian Medical Center**, Peter Olson's colleague.
- She senses her daughter changed after New Year's 2002 and has never been able to find out why.
- **Voice:** *"I fix hearts for a living, Arianna. I know when one is breaking."*

THE DIVINE FAMILY (Cascade Heights, middle class)

Calvin Divine — The Father

- **Born:** February 28, 1953 · **Age:** 51 · **Looks:** early 40s
- **MARTA bus operator for 28 years** (Route 71, Cascade Road). He's a deacon, a union man, and a gentle giant broken by his son's disappearance.
- **Voice:** *"I drive the same route every day in case my boy's at one of the stops."*

Loretta Divine — The Mother

- **Born:** September 12, 1955 · **Age:** 49 · **Looks:** late 30s
- **ER Charge Nurse, Grady Memorial Hospital.** She's fierce and funny, and she's decided she no longer believes in the police.
- **Voice:** *"I've patched up half this city. The other half owes me."*

Darnell "Dee" Divine — The Missing Son

- **Born:** July 7, 1979 · **Last seen:** New Year's Eve 2001, age 22 · **Would be 25 today**
 - A barber and aspiring music producer who was the light of the family. He was walking home from a party off Northside Drive and never arrived.
 - **SECRET:** He was killed by Arianna Cummings' car at about 2:40 AM on January 1, 2002. **Marc-Anthony made his body disappear.**
-

THE JACKSON FAMILY

Former Chief Harold Jackson — The Old Lion

- **Born:** April 4, 1947 · **Age:** 57 · **Looks:** late 40s
- **Chief of Police, APD (1998–2004).** He retired in December 2004 and was succeeded by his daughter-in-law.
- Old-school and proud. He has quiet doubts about how Elxa was appointed, and has quiet guilt about a case he buried in 2000: **the Harlow file.**
- **Voice:** *"I carried a badge 35 years. I know what a favor smells like."*

Denise Jackson — The Mother-in-Law

- **Born:** July 22, 1950 · **Age:** 54 · **Looks:** early 40s
- A retired schoolteacher. She thinks Elxa is too ambitious and the Donohues are too everything.
- **Voice:** *"I didn't raise my son to be the Chief's husband."*

LAW, ORDER & POLITICS

Mayor Josephine "Jo" Whitaker

- **Born:** October 1, 1949 · **Age:** 55 · **Looks:** mid-40s
- **Mayor of Atlanta** in the show's universe. (Soap convention: the show uses fictional officeholders.)
- Brilliant, pragmatic, and compromised. She appointed Elxa after "conversations" with Victor Donohue and Robert Bullock.
- **Voice:** *"I serve the people of Atlanta. The Donohues just happen to be a lot of people."*

Deputy Chief Warren Hughes — The Passed-Over Cop

- **Born:** October 19, 1958 · **Age:** 46 · **Looks:** late 30s
- A 25-year APD veteran and Harold Jackson's protégé. He expected to be Chief, and he wants Elxa to fail.
- **Voice:** *"I've got shoes older than the Chief."*

† Special Agent Kathleen "Kate" Doyle — The Fed

- **Born:** March 8, 1970, South Boston · **Age:** 34 · Irish American
- **FBI Atlanta Field Office, Organized Crime Squad. Lead agent on "Operation Deep Water."**
- A relentless, divorced workaholic. She thinks the Blackwater Syndicate is hiding behind someone rich, and she's right.
- **Voice:** *"Every king thinks the moat's deep enough."*

† Special Agent Daniel "Danny" Reyes — The Partner

- **Born:** June 14, 1975, the Bronx · **Age:** 29 · Puerto Rican
- Doyle's partner. He's charming, a former accountant, and he follows the money. He's also a secret admirer of Sovereign's charity work.
- **Voice:** *"This guy pays hospital bills. I'm supposed to arrest Robin Hood?"*

Gordon Ellis — The Chief of Staff

- **Born:** February 14, 1968 · **Age:** 36 · **Looks:** late 20s
- **Chief of Staff to Congresswoman Jasmine Olson** since 1996. He's a political operative who knows where Jasmine's votes and bodies are buried.
- **Voice:** *"Congresswoman, the truth tested poorly."*

Lawrence Tate — The Fallen DA

- **Born:** July 19, 1951 · **Age:** 53
- The former **Fulton County DA** who lost to Arianna after the September 2004 bribery scandal. He's sure someone set him up, and he's right.
- **Voice:** *"Somebody built my coffin and sold me the nails."*

† Judge Harlan Whitcomb Jr. — The Independent Trustee

- **Born:** April 22, 1956 · **Age:** 48 · White
 - A retired Georgia Court of Appeals judge who holds **Seat 9 on the Crown Council**. He's the son of the attorney who secretly bought Belmont Crest's land for the Donohues. Honorable, independent, and the swing vote on any Disgrace Clause fight.
 - **Voice:** *"My father risked everything for this family. I won't let it destroy itself."*
-

THE UNDERWORLD

Silas "The Undertaker" Merriweather — The Old King

- **Born:** December 14, 1947 · **Age:** 57 · **Looks:** late 40s
- Owns **Merriweather & Sons Funeral Homes** (seven locations). He's also Atlanta's old-school kingpin in gambling, loan-sharking, and numbers.
- He lost the **Summer of Silence (2004)** to Blackwater, and he's waiting for his chance.
- **Alvin Donohue owes him \$4.2 million and several favors.**
- **Voice:** *"Everybody comes to see me eventually. I just like it better when they're breathing."*

† Cyrus Knox — Martin's Shadow

- **Born:** March 2, 1968, Johannesburg · **Age:** 36 · White South African
 - A former mercenary and **Martin Olson's private operator**. He's a fixer, an assassin, and a ghost. He helped with two of Martin's three "accidents."
 - **Voice:** *"Mr. Olson doesn't pay me to ask why. He pays me not to."*
-

MEDIA & SPOTLIGHT

Celeste Vaughn — The Anchor

- **Born:** December 21, 1980 · **Age:** 24 · **Looks:** early 20s

- **Weekend anchor and investigative reporter, WBKG Channel 8 Action News.** She's ambitious and gorgeous, and she's **Marc-Anthony's on-and-off girlfriend.**
- **Her secret goal:** Break the story of who Sovereign is. She doesn't realize she's sleeping with the answer.
- **Voice:** *"I don't chase stories, Marc. Stories chase me. You should know. You're running."*

Bernadette Sinclair — The Columnist

- **Born:** February 27, 1945 · **Age:** 59 · **Looks:** late 40s
- Writes "**Behind the Gates**," the society and gossip column of *The Atlanta Sentinel*, and has since 1974. Her column can make a debutante or bury a marriage.
- She's Constance Donohue's lunch partner. She suspects Connie writes CrestWatch.
- **Voice:** *"Darling, I never print rumors. I print previews."*

† Vince Maretti — The Paparazzo

- **Born:** September 3, 1968, South Philadelphia · **Age:** 36 · Italian American
- The best celebrity photographer in the South. He's staked out the Belmont Crest gate for 10 years. His dream is the first photo of Esther Smilley's twins with their "donor."
- **Voice:** *"Every gate's got a gap."*

BULLOCK & ASSOCIATES

Camille Rhodes, Esq. — The Other Woman

- **Born:** March 3, 1966 · **Age:** 38 · **Looks:** late 20s
- **Senior Partner, Bullock & Associates.** Robert's legal right hand and his mistress since 1999. She's brilliant and patient, and her patience is running out.
- **Voice:** *"I've kept your secrets six years, Robert. Don't make me keep a calendar."*

GRACE'S WORLD

Lionel "Lo" Pierce — The Manager

- **Born:** July 4, 1965 · **Age:** 39 · **Looks:** early 30s
- Grace's manager since her *Sweet Tea* days. He's a hustler with a heart, and he's in deep with record-label people who don't take no for an answer.
- **Voice:** *"Baby girl, platinum is just the beginning. Diamond is the goal."*

Derrick Vance — The Co-Star

- **Born:** January 15, 1979 · **Age:** 25 · **Looks:** early 20s
 - An R&B singer turned actor, **Grace's co-star and new boyfriend**. He's charming on camera and controlling off it.
 - **Warning sign for writers:** He's Marc-Anthony's next "monster" trigger.
 - **Voice:** *"Your brother doesn't scare me." (He should.)*
-

THE SMILLEY ORBIT

Sebastian Kingsley — The Fiancé

- **Born:** April 29, 1977, London · **Age:** 27 · **Looks:** mid-20s · British-Ghanaian
- **Investment banker, Harcourt & Lowe.** He proposed to Esther on **Christmas Eve 2004** in Paris, and she said yes. It's a strategic engagement: Esther wants a respectable husband before the Atlanta move, and Sebastian wants the Smilley fortune.
- **SECRET:** He's been hired by Desmond Smilley to report on everything Esther does.
- **Voice:** *"Love is a merger, darling. I'm simply doing due diligence."*

† Beatrix "Nanny Bea" Pennington — The Nanny

- **Born:** July 9, 1961, Surrey, England · **Age:** 43 · White British
- A Norland-trained nanny who has raised Emma and Victoria since birth. She's fiercely protective and adores them.
- She has noticed that the girls' "donor" must have been extraordinary, and that Esther flinches whenever the Bullock boy is on television.
- **Voice:** *"Miss Victoria, we do not climb the curtains. We admire them."*

Thaddeus Crowe — The Smilley Shield

- **Born:** November 20, 1964 · **Age:** 40 · **Looks:** early 30s
 - **Head of Smilley family security.** He's a former U.S. Secret Service agent. BSI is his professional rival, and Blackwater is his professional obsession.
 - **Voice:** *"In my old job I took a bullet for the President. In this one I'd take it for the twins."*
-

ALVIN'S SECRET FAMILY

Rochelle Banks — The Secret Keeper

- **Born:** May 21, 1972, College Park · **Age:** 32 · **Looks:** mid-20s
- A hair salon owner in College Park. She met Alvin Donohue (then 20) at a Freaknik party in April 1991 when she was 18. Their fling lasted until Thanksgiving 1991. She never told him about their son, because she "didn't want Donohue money to Donohue my baby."
- **Voice:** *"I didn't need his name. I needed his absence."*

Tremaine Banks — The Unknown Donohue

- **Born:** August 16, 1992 · **Age:** 12
 - A seventh-grader. He's brilliant, funny, and restless, and he has **the Donohue eyes**. He wants to know who his father is. **Future storyline:** Marc-Anthony meets Tremaine through his mentoring program and sees the resemblance first.
-

BLACKWATER'S SEVEN — Profiles

(Structure in Document 06.)

Tobias Okafor — "The Ledger"

- **Born:** March 30, 1980, Houston · **Age:** 24 · Nigerian American
- MIT mathematics dropout. **CFO of BSI**. He can move a billion dollars through nine countries before breakfast.
- **Voice:** *"Money isn't dirty. People are dirty. Money just needs a bath."*

Keisha "Ghost" Lattimore — "The Ghost"

- **Born:** November 4, 1979, Decatur, Georgia · **Age:** 25
- A Georgia Tech dropout and self-taught hacker. **BSI Director of Cyber**. She runs the Archive, the Syndicate's files on everyone who matters.
- **Voice:** *"There's no such thing as private. There's just 'not yet.'"*

Roman Gaines — "The Hammer"

- **Born:** August 3, 1976, Fayetteville, North Carolina · **Age:** 28
- Former U.S. Army Ranger with two combat deployments. **BSI Director of Global Operations**. He's quiet, devout, and terrifying.
- **Voice:** *"I only say it once."*

Dolores "Mama Dee" Whitfield — "The Tithe"

- **Born:** January 12, 1951 · **Age:** 53 (turns 54 Wednesday, January 12, 2005)

- Owns **Dee's Kitchen**, a legendary soul food restaurant on Ralph David Abernathy Blvd in the West End. She's the Syndicate's heart and its conscience. She's the only person who has ever slapped Sovereign and lived.
- **Voice:** *"Eat first. Then we'll talk about who needs to disappear."*

Rashad "Saint" Mayfield — "The Saint"

- **Born:** September 18, 1981 · **Age:** 23
- Son of the Bullocks' longtime driver, and Marc's childhood brother. He owns the **Saint's Car Wash** chain (14 locations). He runs the streets for Blackwater, and he's a founding member.
- **Voice:** *"They call me Saint 'cause I forgive. Once."*

Lt. Gen. Walter Bassett, U.S. Army (Ret.) — BSI President

- **Born:** June 6, 1944 · **Age:** 60 · **Looks:** early 50s
- A retired three-star general, born on D-Day. **President & COO of BSI.** He's honorable, and he's **completely unaware of the Syndicate.**
- **Voice:** *"Son, in forty years I've never served a man I didn't trust. Don't make you the first."*

Brielle Sutton — The Assistant

- **Born:** April 8, 1983 · **Age:** 21
- Spelman senior and **Executive Assistant to Marc-Anthony.** She's hyper-organized and funny, and she's noticed that her boss's calendar has holes in it.
- **Voice:** *"Mr. Bullock, you have a 3 o'clock, a 3:15, and a 3:30 that doesn't exist. Should I keep pretending?"*

IN-UNIVERSE MEDIA OUTLETS (for the News & Fan layers)

Outlet	Type	Voice
<i>The Atlanta Sentinel</i>	Fictional major daily newspaper	Serious. Front page, Metro, Business. Bernadette Sinclair's "Behind the Gates."
WBKG Channel 8 Action News	Fictional Atlanta TV station	Breaking news. Celeste Vaughn.
<i>Peachtree Business Chronicle</i>	Fictional weekly business paper	DGH vs. Smiley coverage
<i>Atlanta Daily World</i>	Real historic Black newspaper	Community, legacy, church
<i>Jet</i>, <i>*Ebony</i>, <i>Essence</i>, <i>*Black Enterprise</i>	Real national Black magazines (2005)	Covers, weddings, "Black Royalty" features
<i>Forbes</i>, <i>*Fortune</i>, <i>*The Wall Street Journal</i>	Real business press	Net worths, deals
<i>Soap-style tabloids</i> (e.g., <i>Star</i>, <i>Us Weekly</i>)	Real tabloids	Esther's twins, Grace's romance, Marc's dating life

Outlet	Type	Voice
CrestWatch (Blogger)	Anonymous gossip blog, secretly written by Connie Donohue	Catty, leaked, and first with every rumor
"Find Dee" (LiveJournal)	Harmony's blog about her missing brother	Heartbreaking
BlackPlanet, MySpace, AOL message boards, LiveJournal	Fan and public reaction (2005-accurate)	The people's voice